



THE IMPACT LEDGER

STORIES OF IMPACT. CHANGE THAT MATTERS.

BEYOND PROFIT

*Spotlighting leaders
who are building a
better tomorrow.*

16
IDEAS
DRIVING
REAL
CHANGE

INNOVATION,
PURPOSE,
IMPACT.

“
*The smallest
actions today
create the
biggest impact
tomorrow.*

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CHAIRMAN: VINIL REDDY

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: LAHARI RAMI REDDY

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: VARANASI ADITYA KIRAN

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR: JATIN JANGIR

EDITOR (FEATURES): JOHN PAUL DIRISHIPAMU

SENIOR DEPUTY EDITORS: PRINCY SELSIYA

PHOTO DEPARTMENT: HANS RAJ, PAVAN, RISHAB, ASHOK

PHOTO RESEARCHERS: AARADHYA

ART DEPARTMENT: EKTA DIMPLE

PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: LAASYA, NAVEEN KUMAR

IMPACT TEAM: DIVYA, HAFSA, SHANAYA

GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: MALLESHWAR



**VOLUME: 1 NUMBER 1: FOR THE MONTH JULY,
PUBLISHES EVERY MONTH**

PUBLISHER :

TASW PUBLICATIONS INDIA PVT. LTD.

NO OF COPIES: 20,000+

PRINTED BY: RE.DZINR

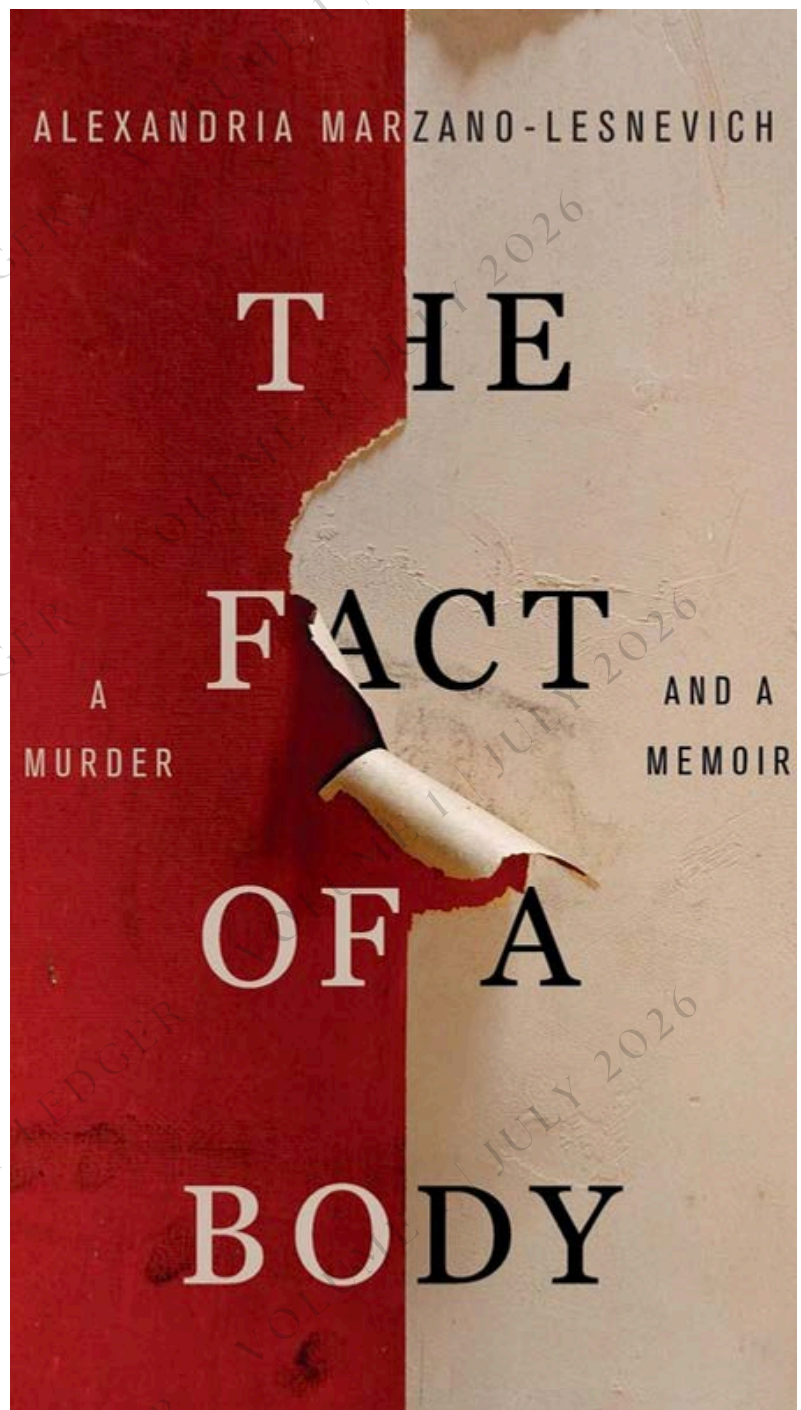


ABOUT IMPACT LEDGER

The Impact Ledger is a premium publication dedicated to celebrating impact, fostering knowledge, and inspiring meaningful change. Conceived as a platform where purpose meets perspective, the magazine brings together compelling stories of corporate social responsibility, non-governmental organisations, social entrepreneurs, visionary leaders, and changemakers transforming communities through innovation, compassion, and sustainable action. Beyond its commitment to social impact, The Impact Ledger offers a rich and diverse editorial experience, featuring national affairs, business, technology, healthcare, education, governance, public policy, sustainability, environmental conservation, sports, lifestyle, culture, and emerging innovations shaping the world around us. Every edition is thoughtfully curated with exclusive interviews, expert insights, inspiring success stories, in-depth features, thought-provoking analyses, fascinating facts, interactive quizzes, brain teasers, and knowledge-driven content designed to inform, engage, and inspire readers across generations. More than a magazine, The Impact Ledger is a trusted voice that bridges knowledge with purpose, celebrates excellence with integrity, and empowers individuals and organizations to create a lasting difference. It stands as a testament to the belief that informed minds inspire meaningful action, transformative stories shape a better future, and every edition leaves an enduring legacy of impact.

For Queries & Assistance regarding the magazine,
please feel free to reach out to +91 9502343555
(Monday to Saturday | 9:30 AM – 6:30 PM)
Email us at theimpactledger@gmail.com

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EDITORIAL NOTE

Dear Readers,

It is with immense pride and gratitude that we welcome you to The Impact Ledger, a magazine dedicated to celebrating the people, organisations, and ideas that are shaping a better world.

In every corner of our society, extraordinary work is taking place. A corporate invests in the future of education through its CSR initiatives. An NGO transforms the lives of underserved communities. A social entrepreneur introduces innovative solutions to age-old challenges. Volunteers dedicate their time to causes larger than themselves, driven only by the desire to make a difference. These efforts may not always make headlines, but they create meaningful and lasting change where it matters most.

The Impact Ledger was envisioned as a platform to bring these inspiring stories to the forefront. We believe that every initiative, regardless of its size, carries the power to inspire countless others. By documenting these journeys, we not only recognise the dedication behind them but also encourage collaboration, innovation, and a shared commitment to social progress.

This edition presents a diverse collection of stories that reflect the spirit of compassion, responsibility, and leadership. From transformative CSR initiatives and impactful nonprofit work to sustainability efforts, social innovation, and inspiring individuals, every page is a reminder that positive change is possible when purpose meets action.

As Chief Editor, I firmly believe that storytelling is one of the most powerful catalysts for change. When stories of impact are shared, they encourage dialogue, foster collaboration, inspire innovation, and motivate others to become active participants in nation-building and social development. It is through this collective exchange of ideas and experiences that we strengthen the culture of responsibility and create opportunities for meaningful partnerships.

I extend my sincere appreciation to every contributor, corporate leader, nonprofit organization, development professional, and changemaker who has shared their journey within these pages. Their work serves as a reminder that sustainable progress is achieved through collaboration, integrity, and an unwavering commitment to the greater good.

As your journey through this magazine, we hope you discover more than achievements; you discover hope, resilience, and the collective power of communities working together for a better tomorrow. Let these stories inspire new ideas, meaningful partnerships, and a renewed belief that each one of us has the ability to create an impact.

Together, let us continue to celebrate impact, honour purpose, and inspire generations to come. Because every story matters. Every effort counts. Every impact deserves to be remembered.

Lahari Rami Reddy
Editor-In-Chief
The Impact Ledger

TRAGEDY OF ALMOST....

Almost was never enough....

Written by:

D. M. Ruddy

*A poignant story of unspoken words, hidden bucket lists, and the enduring power of almost.
Releasing on 20th August 2026*



RAMKY FOUNDATION

Where Purpose Meets Progress



*The true measure of impact
is not in numbers alone, but
in the lives transformed.”*



For nearly two decades, Ramky Foundation has been a catalyst for meaningful and sustainable social transformation across India. Established in 2006 as the Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) arm of the Ramky Group, the Foundation was founded on the belief that business success carries a responsibility to create lasting value for society. Guided by this philosophy, it has consistently worked to improve the quality of life of under-served communities by addressing critical social, economic, and environmental challenges. Through strategic partnerships with governments, educational institutions, healthcare organizations, local communities, and civil society, the Foundation has built a strong legacy of inclusive growth, ensuring that development reaches those who need it most. Its mission extends beyond philanthropy it is about empowering individuals, strengthening communities, and creating opportunities that lead to lasting, measurable impact.

Today, Ramky Foundation operates across multiple states, implementing holistic development programs that focus on education, healthcare, women empowerment, skill development, environmental conservation, natural resource management, sanitation, rural development, and livelihood enhancement. Every initiative is carefully designed with sustainability at its core, enabling communities to become self-reliant rather than dependent on temporary assistance. The Foundation believes that true transformation happens when people are equipped with the knowledge, skills, confidence, and resources to shape their own futures. By integrating multiple development sectors into a community-centric approach, Ramky Foundation has become one of India's most respected CSR organizations, recognized for delivering practical, inclusive, and sustainable solutions that create lasting social value.

FOCUS AREAS



EDUCATION



HEALTHCARE



NATURAL
RESOURCE
MANAGEMENT



WOMEN
EMPOWERMENT



SKILL
DEVELOPMENT



ENVIRONMENTAL
CONSERVATION



RURAL
DEVELOPMENT



LIVELIHOOD
ENHANCEMENT

“These focus areas are interconnected because improving one aspect of life often creates positive change in many others.”



Educating Today, Empowering Tomorrow

Education is more than classroom learning it is the foundation upon which dreams are built. Recognizing this, Ramky Foundation has invested significantly in improving access to quality education for children and young adults, especially those from rural and economically disadvantaged backgrounds.

The Foundation supports schools by upgrading infrastructure, building classrooms, improving sanitation facilities, providing digital learning resources, and distributing educational materials. Beyond physical infrastructure, it also encourages holistic learning through scholarships, mentoring programs, career guidance sessions, and educational awareness campaigns.

Understanding that today's job market demands practical skills alongside academic knowledge, Ramky Foundation has expanded its efforts into vocational education and skill development. Young people receive industry-relevant training in various trades, helping them gain employment or establish their own enterprises. By equipping youth with employable skills, the Foundation empowers them to become financially independent while contributing positively to their communities. For countless students, these initiatives have transformed education from a distant aspiration into an achievable reality.

Health That Reaches Every Doorstep

Healthy communities are the cornerstone of sustainable development. Yet, access to quality healthcare remains limited in many rural regions of India. Ramky Foundation addresses this gap by taking healthcare directly to the people. Its healthcare initiatives include free medical camps, preventive health screenings, maternal and child healthcare programs, nutrition awareness campaigns, eye care services, sanitation drives, vaccination awareness, and health education sessions.

The Foundation believes that awareness is as important as treatment. Community outreach programs educate families about hygiene, balanced nutrition, safe drinking water, disease prevention, menstrual health, and preventive healthcare practices. These efforts have helped thousands of individuals adopt healthier lifestyles while reducing preventable illnesses.

Growing Greener, Living Better

Environmental conservation has always been central to the Foundation's mission. Sustainable development is impossible without protecting the natural resources that support human life. Through watershed management, rainwater harvesting, afforestation, soil conservation, biodiversity restoration, and sustainable agriculture initiatives, Ramky Foundation works to restore ecological balance while improving rural livelihoods.



M.V. RAMI REDDY
PRESIDENT,
RAMKY FOUNDATION

Its environmental programs also encourage communities to actively participate in conservation efforts. Tree plantation drives, waste management campaigns, and environmental awareness workshops inspire citizens to become responsible stewards of nature. For farming communities, improved water conservation and better soil management have led to increased agricultural productivity, greater resilience to climate challenges, and enhanced income opportunities. These initiatives demonstrate that environmental sustainability and economic development can successfully coexist.

Together Towards a Better Tomorrow

Every school transformed, every medical camp conducted, every tree planted, and every woman empowered reflects the collective efforts of countless individuals working towards a shared purpose. Behind every milestone is a team committed to improving lives with empathy, professionalism, and unwavering dedication. By continuously learning, adapting, and innovating, the Ramky Foundation team ensures that its programs remain relevant to changing social and environmental needs.

Together Towards a Better Tomorrow

As India moves towards a more inclusive and sustainable future, Ramky Foundation continues to stand as an example of responsible corporate citizenship. With visionary leadership, dedicated professionals, strong community partnerships, and an unwavering commitment to service, the Foundation is creating opportunities that extend far beyond immediate assistance. By embracing innovation, sustainability, and collaborative action, it continues to address emerging social and environmental challenges while fostering resilient and self-reliant communities. It is nurturing confidence, restoring dignity, protecting the environment, and empowering communities to build their own future.

For the Ramky Foundation, social responsibility is not simply a commitment it is a journey of transforming lives, strengthening communities, and creating a lasting legacy of hope for generations to come.



**Durgapur Iswar Chandra Vidyasagar
Public High School
&
Suren Chandra Modern School.**



The Future Belongs to Those Who Create Impact Discover how CSRNOW is redefining Corporate Responsibility and shaping India's future.

By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

About CSRNOW

CSRNOW is one of India's leading platforms dedicated to promoting Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), sustainability, and social impact. Established to bridge the gap between corporate organizations, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), social enterprises, policymakers, and changemakers, CSRNOW serves as a collaborative ecosystem where ideas are transformed into meaningful action. Its mission is to encourage partnerships that create long-lasting social and environmental impact while supporting the nation's sustainable development goals.

Unlike a traditional conference, CSRNOW functions as a year-round platform that facilitates networking, knowledge sharing, recognition, and collaboration. It brings together industry leaders, CSR professionals, development experts, government representatives, and nonprofit organizations to exchange best practices and develop innovative solutions to pressing social challenges.

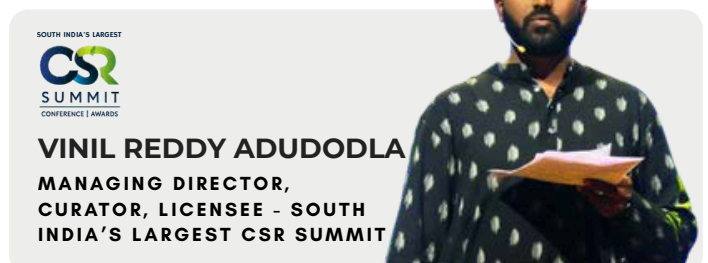
Vision and Mission

CSRNOW believes that sustainable development can only be achieved through collective effort. Its vision is to create a strong bridge between businesses and social organizations by encouraging responsible corporate practices and impactful community initiatives. The platform promotes transparency, innovation, and measurable social outcomes while inspiring organizations to integrate sustainability into their core business strategies.

“TRUE SOCIAL IMPACT ISN'T BUILT ON SHORT-TERM FIXES IT IS FORGED WHEN PURPOSE MEETS PROGRESS TO TURN TEMPORARY CHANGE INTO AN ENDURING LEGACY.”

In addition to hosting conferences and networking events, CSRNOW recognizes outstanding CSR initiatives through awards, supports dialogue on Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) practices, and encourages organizations to adopt responsible and inclusive development models. Its activities focus on education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, women empowerment, rural development, skill enhancement, and community welfare.

By fostering strong collaborative networks, CSRNOW empowers corporate entities, grassroots non-profits, and policy makers to align their strengths and scale their social impact far beyond traditional philanthropy. Through dedicated capacity-building workshops, actionable research insights, and data-driven evaluation tools, the platform helps organizations design long-term programs that address systemic challenges rather than short-term fixes. Furthermore, by promoting accountability, open dialogue, and cross-sector leadership, CSRNOW strives to embed a culture of continuous social responsibility deep within modern corporate leadership. Ultimately, this comprehensive approach ensures that every social investment creates a lasting, positive ripple effect across communities driving systemic change and establishing a more inclusive, resilient, and equitable future for generations to come.



CSRNOW CSR SUMMIT 2026: FROM CHANGE TO LEGACY

A Premier Platform for Social Impact

The 3rd Edition of the CSRNOW CSR Summit 2026, scheduled for 25 July 2026 at Brahma Kumaris Shanti Sarovar, Hyderabad, is recognized as South India's Largest CSR Summit. Held under the inspiring theme "From Change to Legacy - Enduring Impact & Systemic Transformation," the summit brings together corporate leaders, NGOs, government representatives, policymakers, philanthropists, academicians, social entrepreneurs, and development professionals on a single platform.

The summit serves as a space for meaningful conversations on responsible business practices, sustainable development, ESG, innovation, and community transformation. Through keynote sessions, expert panel discussions, networking opportunities, and collaborative workshops, participants explore practical solutions to today's social and environmental challenges.

Promoting Collaboration for Greater Impact

One of the defining features of the CSRNOW CSR Summit is its emphasis on collaboration. The event enables corporate CSR teams to connect with NGOs, social enterprises, and implementation partners to identify impactful projects and develop long-term partnerships. It also provides organizations with opportunities to share successful CSR models, exchange knowledge, and learn from industry experts.

The summit also recognizes outstanding contributions to society through its prestigious CSR Awards, celebrating organizations and individuals whose initiatives have created measurable and sustainable social impact. These recognitions encourage innovation and inspire more businesses to embrace responsible corporate citizenship.

Building a Better Future

As Corporate Social Responsibility continues to evolve beyond compliance, platforms like CSRNOW play an increasingly important role in shaping India's development journey. By fostering partnerships, encouraging innovation, and promoting sustainable practices, the CSRNOW CSR Summit demonstrates that meaningful change is achieved through collective action.

With its focus on collaboration, knowledge sharing, and social innovation, CSRNOW continues to inspire organizations to move beyond short-term initiatives and build a lasting legacy of positive impact. By providing a platform for meaningful dialogue, strategic partnerships, and the exchange of successful practices, the summit encourages stakeholders to work collectively towards addressing some of society's most pressing challenges. The summit stands as a powerful reminder that when businesses, governments, NGOs, and communities work together with a common purpose, they can create sustainable solutions that improve lives and contribute to a more inclusive and prosperous society.



Expanding Grassroots Impact

Central to this vision is the deep, on-the-ground engagement with local communities to ensure that developmental initiatives address genuine, contextual needs. By facilitating direct collaboration between corporate decision-makers and grassroots changemakers, CSRNOW helps bridge the gap between high-level policy and real-world execution. This localized focus ensures that resources are directed toward high-priority areas such as clean water accessibility, quality rural education, and localized skill development creating self-sustaining ecosystems that empower marginalized populations to thrive independently over the long term.

Harnessing Innovation and Technology

In an increasingly digital world, leveraging technology and data analytics is essential for scaling social impact and maximizing return on investment. CSRNOW emphasizes digital monitoring frameworks, GIS mapping, and transparent reporting tools that allow organizations to track milestones and measure outcomes in real time. By integrating data-driven strategies into welfare initiatives, corporate partners can optimize resources, reduce redundancies, and ensure every contribution delivers tangible, verifiable benefits to local communities.

Harnessing Innovation and Technology

Building a sustainable future requires nurturing a new generation of empathetic, socially conscious leaders across corporate and civic sectors. CSRNOW serves as an incubator for innovative ideas by engaging young professionals, social entrepreneurs, and researchers to tackle complex socioeconomic challenges. Through mentorship and collaborative forums, the initiative instills proactive responsibility to ensure future growth balances economic, social, and environmental goals.

INDIA'S GOLDEN JULY: A REMARKABLE COMMONWEALTH GAMES CAMPAIGN

By The Impact Ledger | Sports bureau | July 2026

The Commonwealth Games 2026 marks another remarkable chapter in the history of one of the world's most celebrated multi-sport events. The Games bring together athletes from across the Commonwealth to compete in a spirit of friendship, respect, and excellence.

After unforeseen challenges in the original hosting plans, Glasgow once again stepped forward to host the event, showcasing its world-class sporting infrastructure and commitment to international sporting excellence. Having successfully hosted the Games in 2014, the city has demonstrated its ability to organize a sustainable, athlete focused, and memorable global event.

The 2026 edition emphasizes not only sporting excellence but also sustainability, inclusivity, innovation, and community engagement. These values reflect the evolving nature of international sporting events, where the impact extends far beyond the competition arenas.

A Global Gathering of Sporting Talent

The Commonwealth Games continue to unite athletes from more than 70 Commonwealth nations and territories. Over ten days of competition, participants compete across multiple sporting disciplines, creating unforgettable moments of determination, teamwork, and national pride.

The Games provide an important platform for both experienced champions and emerging young athletes to demonstrate their skills on an international stage. Every medal won represents years of dedication, discipline, and perseverance.

India's Journey at Glasgow 2026

India once again enters the Commonwealth Games with high expectations across several sporting disciplines. Indian athletes have consistently delivered exceptional performances in events such as athletics, weightlifting, wrestling, boxing, badminton, table tennis, shooting and para sports.

The nation's growing investment in sports infrastructure, scientific training methods, and grassroots talent development has strengthened India's position among the leading sporting nations of the Commonwealth. These sustained efforts are not only producing world-class athletes but also fostering a strong sporting culture that inspires future generations to pursue excellence on the global stage.

“DREAMS ARE FREE. GOALS HAVE A COST... TIME,
EFFORT, SACRIFICE, AND SWEAT



Several young athletes are also making their Commonwealth debut, symbolizing the bright future of Indian sports. Their participation reflects the country's expanding talent pool and commitment to nurturing the next generation of champions.

Sports Beyond Competition

The Commonwealth Games represent much more than medals and records. They celebrate diversity, equality, cultural exchange, and international friendship. Athletes from different backgrounds come together to inspire millions through their determination and sportsmanship.

The inclusion of integrated Para sports further strengthens the Games' commitment to accessibility and equal opportunity. It demonstrates that excellence knows no physical boundaries and that sport has the power to unite communities across all abilities.

TOP MEDALLING NATIONS

- **AUSTRALIA:** 51 GOLD, 24 SILVER, 35 BRONZE (110 TOTAL)
- **ENGLAND:** 15 GOLD, 30 SILVER, 20 BRONZE (65 TOTAL)
- **CANADA:** 15 GOLD, 13 SILVER, 17 BRONZE (45 TOTAL)
- **SCOTLAND:** 9 GOLD, 7 SILVER, 9 BRONZE (25 TOTAL)
- **NIGERIA:** 8 GOLD, 5 SILVER, 3 BRONZE (16 TOTAL)



The Commonwealth Games also leave a lasting legacy by encouraging youth participation in sports and inspiring future generations to pursue excellence. Beyond the competition, the Games strengthen cooperation among member nations and showcase the transformative power of sport in building a more inclusive and united global community.

Economic and Social Impact

Hosting an event of this magnitude generates significant benefits for the local economy. Tourism, hospitality, transportation, retail, and small businesses all experience increased activity during the Games. Beyond the economic impact, the event leaves behind improved sporting infrastructure, enhanced community participation in sports, and lasting international recognition for the host city. The Games also encourage volunteerism, youth engagement, and cultural collaboration, creating opportunities for people from diverse backgrounds to contribute to a shared global celebration. Additionally, strategic investments in sustainable urban redevelopment and public transit yield lasting civic benefits long after the closing ceremony. The heightened sense of national pride and unity fosters stronger community cohesion, inspiring the next generation of aspiring athletes.



Inspiring the Next Generation

One of the greatest legacies of the Commonwealth Games is its ability to inspire young people. Watching athletes overcome challenges and represent their nations motivates children and aspiring sportspersons to dream bigger, work harder, and believe in their own abilities. Schools, sports academies, and community organizations often witness increased participation in sports following major international competitions, creating healthier and more active communities. Moreover, seeing diverse role models excel on a global stage helps break down social barriers, proving that dedication and resilience can overcome any background. Interactive youth clinics and athlete mentorship programs run alongside the Games give aspiring talent direct access to elite guidance and encouragement. This surge in grassroots participation encourages local governments to invest more heavily in accessible, modern sports facilities for public use.

Technology Transforming the Fan Experience

Technology continues to redefine how fans experience international sporting events. Live digital broadcasting, real-time performance analytics, interactive mobile applications, artificial intelligence, and social media platforms enable supporters across the world to stay connected with every event. Athletes also benefit from innovations in sports science, wearable technology, injury prevention, nutrition planning, and performance monitoring, helping them compete at their highest potential. Furthermore, augmented and virtual reality (AR/VR) allow spectators to access personalized camera angles and immersive 360-degree views, bringing distant viewers straight onto the field. Inside smart venues, IoT-powered navigation, automated food ordering, and contactless ticketing eliminate wait times to streamline the live event experience.

Looking Ahead

The Commonwealth Games 2026 stand as a reminder that sport has the extraordinary power to connect people beyond borders, cultures, and languages. Every race, every match, and every medal tells a story of resilience, discipline, and human potential. As Glasgow once again welcomes the Commonwealth family, the world celebrates not only athletic excellence but also the enduring values of unity, respect, inclusion, and hope. The Games leave behind memories that inspire generations and reinforce the belief that through sport, nations grow stronger together. As the global community looks toward the future, this gathering serves as a vital beacon for peace, mutual understanding, and international goodwill. The innovative, scaled-down model introduced by the host city sets a sustainable blueprint for future major sporting events worldwide.



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GAANA BAJAANA: BUILDING COMMUNITIES BEYOND MUSIC

By The Impact Ledger | Music bureau | July 2026

A Vision Born from Friendship

It all started with a group of friends who believed that no one should have to feel alone in a city full of people. United by a shared vision, six friends Sainandhan Jilla, Akhil Davula, Anji Reddy Boda, Shivasai Balbari, Agrati Sheela, and Abhiram Beemari met during their time at Anurag University and came together with one simple goal: to create a space where people could connect, share moments, and build meaningful relationships.

What started as a simple idea has now grown into Gaana Bajaana, a community driven initiative that is transforming lives through the power of music and human connection.

The Inspiration Behind the Initiative

The idea behind Gaana Bajaana was shaped by the experiences of the founders. While growing up, many of them enjoyed the warmth of close-knit communities where festivals, neighbourhood gatherings, and evenings with family and friends naturally brought people together.

However, as they moved to cities for higher education and careers, they noticed that meaningful conversations had become increasingly rare. Despite living among thousands of people, many individuals were silently struggling with loneliness and social isolation. These shared experiences inspired the team to create a platform that could bring people back together.

Creating a Community for Everyone

As the friends reflected on these experiences, they realised this wasn't just their personal story it was a reality faced by millions. At the same time, even simple social outings had become expensive, making it difficult for many people to participate.

Determined to change this, they envisioned an affordable and inclusive community where people of all ages, professions, and backgrounds could come together without barriers. Their mission was simple: to help people form genuine friendships and rediscover the joy of meaningful human connection.

The Beginning of a Beautiful Journey

That vision became a reality on 7 March, when the first edition of Gaana Bajaana was organised at Narapalli, with McDonald's serving as the venue partner.

To ensure accessibility, tickets were priced at just ₹79, allowing everyone to participate. Around 100 people, including students, IT professionals, entrepreneurs, artists, homemakers, and senior citizens, attended the event not merely to enjoy music, but to experience something many had been missing: a genuine sense of belonging.

Music That Brings Hearts Together

Every aspect of the event was carefully designed to encourage interaction. Instead of performing on a separate stage, musicians sat among the audience while everyone gathered together in one large circle.

A simple request to sing or share song lyrics often became the beginning of a conversation, and those conversations gradually blossomed into lasting friendships. For many participants, it was the first time in a long while that they felt truly connected to the people around them.

Growing Beyond Music

After five successful editions, Gaana Bajaana has evolved into much more than a music-jamming initiative. Today, it is a vibrant community where people genuinely Meet, Connect, and Grow. The initiative continues to strengthen meaningful relationships through shared experiences and community engagement. Understanding that relationships should not end when the music stops, the team introduced Mata Muchata, a support community where anyone experiencing loneliness or emotional distress can always find someone willing to listen.



“One good thing about music, when the music hits, you feel no pain.”



In addition to music sessions, the initiative regularly organizes cricket and badminton meet-ups, café gatherings, networking sessions, workshops, open mic events, and several other community driven activities that help members stay connected throughout the year.

Creating Real-Life Opportunities

The impact of Gaana Bajaana extends far beyond entertainment. It is rebuilding human connections in an increasingly isolated world by bringing together people from different walks of life.

Many participants have found mentors, collaborators, business partners, internships, and even employment opportunities through the relationships they built within the community. Independent musicians, student startups, local brands, and emerging creators have also discovered a platform to showcase their talents and reach wider audiences.

Above all, the initiative continues to support emotional well being by creating a safe and welcoming environment where everyone feels heard, accepted, and valued.



Looking Towards the Future

The founders envision taking Gaana Bajaana to towns and cities across India, spreading its message of connection and belonging to more communities.

They also plan to launch Satvikam, an initiative inspired by the traditions of rural Telangana. Satvikam aims to celebrate cultural heritage through Oggu Katha, Dappu performances, community cooking, and other traditional gatherings that revive the spirit of togetherness.

Their mission extends beyond organizing events they aspire to rebuild the culture of communities coming together, creating meaningful relationships, and preserving traditions for future generations.



A Movement That Connects People

Gaana Bajaana is much more than a music initiative it is a movement dedicated to rebuilding human connections and creating opportunities for people to grow together. By inspiring individuals to Meet.Connect.Grow., it continues to transform strangers into friends, friendships into opportunities, and communities into families. Every gathering creates a space where meaningful conversations begin and lasting relationships are built. It empowers people from diverse backgrounds to collaborate, support one another, and celebrate the joy of togetherness. Through the universal language of music, Gaana Bajaana fosters a culture of belonging, trust, and shared experiences that inspire positive change.

"Because, at the end of the day, your network is your net worth."

THE GOLDEN GLOW OF TELANGANA:

Unveiling the Mystic Art of Nirmal

By The Impact Ledger | Art and Culture bureau | July 2026

"Every stroke of gold tells a story of survival, every color a whisper from our ancestors."

-An old Naqash adage

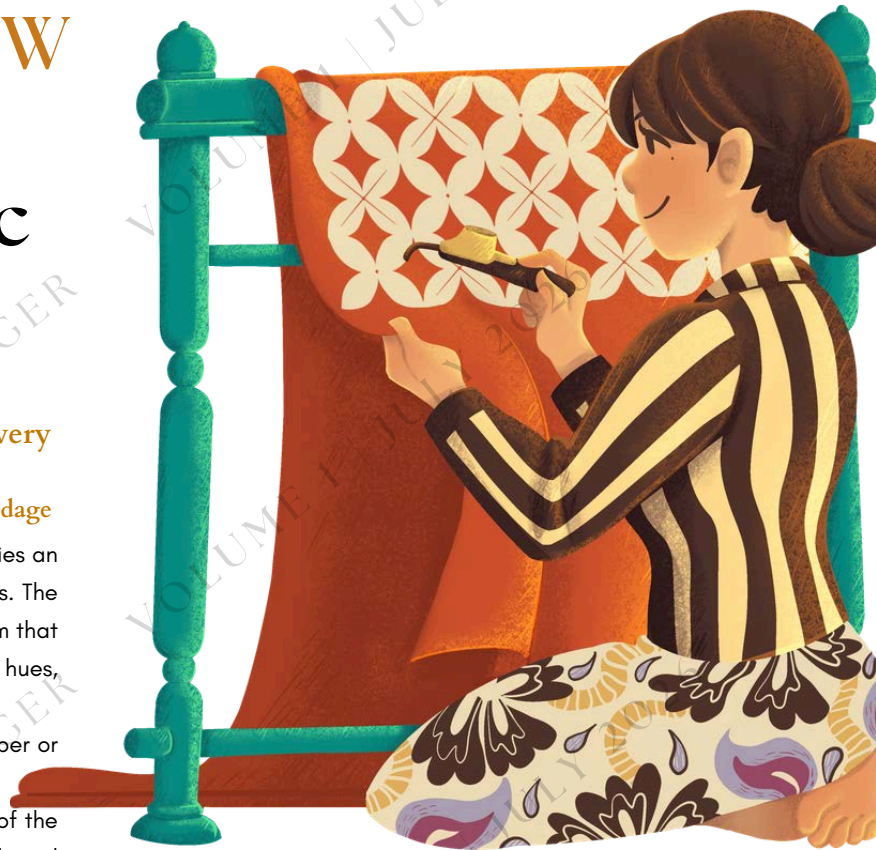
Nestled in the quiet, historic corridors of northern Telangana lies an artistic legacy that has quietly endured for over four centuries. The historic town of Nirmal is home to a unique traditional art form that is instantly recognizable by its deep, luminous golden hues, intricate linework, and an unmistakable aesthetic presence. Unlike conventional Indian folk arts executed on standard paper or canvas, authentic Nirmal Paintings are crafted entirely on lacquered wood. They serve as a brilliant visual chronicle of the Deccan's cultural identity, seamlessly weaving together local rural folklore, royal history, and profound mythological narratives.

From the Blacksmith's Fire to the Nizam's Court:

The story of Nirmal art is deeply intertwined with the shifting political landscape of medieval India. The artisan community behind this craft, known as the Naqash, originally traces its roots back to the 14th century during the golden era of the Kakatiya Dynasty. Interestingly, the town of Nirmal was initially a strategic foundry hub that manufactured heavy ammunition, war cannons, and weaponry for local armies. When they weren't forging weapons, these talented craftsmen turned their hands to designing intricately carved wooden toys, furniture, and decorative panels.



By the 18th century, the Mughals grew deeply enamored with the striking gold-on-black contrast of the Naqash work. They extended generous royal patronage to the artisans, prompting the inclusion of sophisticated Persian motifs, such as elaborate floral arabesques and grand hunting scenes. Later, under the Nizams of Hyderabad, the art form achieved world-class export status.



The Visual Identity: Themes and Motifs

At first glance, a Nirmal painting commands attention through its dramatic backdrop. The central figures fluid, expressive, and gracefully proportioned are set against a deep, dark canvas, traditionally midnight black or rich maroon. This layout makes the vibrant pigments and golden detailing burst forward with near-three-dimensional intensity.

The thematic repertoire of Nirmal paintings is remarkably vast, capturing both the sacred and the mundane:

Epic Narratives: Scenes from the Ramayana and Mahabharata form the bedrock of the narrative style, often portraying grand moments like Sri Rama's coronation (Pattabhishekam).

The Rustic Ethos: Far from just catering to kings, the artisans beautifully document everyday village existence farmers tilling emerald fields, rural women balancing water pots, and folk musicians.

Flora and Fauna: Nature is deeply revered. Elephants (symbolizing royal majesty) and peacocks (representing absolute grace) are painted with remarkable, lifelike accuracy.

The Alchemy of Wood and Gold

Authentic Nirmal art is an incredibly labor-intensive, multi-stage process that requires months of patience.





The Making of Nirmal Art

The process begins with a lightweight, seasoned wooden base, typically crafted from Poniki wood or teak, which is carefully cut into planks and sanded until perfectly smooth. A thick primer known as Lappam, made from sawdust and tamarind seed paste, is then applied to fill minor cracks and protect the surface from moisture. Once prepared, the artwork receives multiple coats of a smooth background color, usually nitrocellulose black or crimson, creating the perfect canvas. Skilled artisans then draw intricate white chalk outlines freehand before bringing the design to life with squirrel-hair brushes and organic pigments. The final stage is the most distinctive, where fine herbal and mineral gold powder is delicately applied to highlight jewelry, garments, and decorative elements, giving Nirmal Art its iconic golden glow.

How do Nirmal artisans traditionally make the golden paint from herbal extracts and minerals?

The dazzling gold finish that defines traditional Nirmal paintings is the result of a fascinating, closely guarded ancestral alchemy. Rather than using actual melted gold which would be too heavy and expensive for extensive use the Naqash artisans historically formulated a deceptive, brilliant gold pigment entirely out of locally sourced minerals, plant extracts, and herbal juices. This ancestral process relies on a clever chemical synergy:

1. The Mineral Base (The Herbal Alchemy)

The foundation of the gold paint starts with a meticulous blending of herbal juices and natural metallic compounds. Artisans traditionally extract juices from specific wild herbs and local plants, combining them with ground minerals and natural gums. A key traditional technique involves utilizing unique plant extracts that react chemically when processed, producing a deep, golden-yellow hue that beautifully mimics the brilliance of precious metals. The mixture is carefully prepared before application, ensuring a smooth texture and lasting finish.

2. Natural Binders and Fixatives

To transform these raw minerals and herbal extracts into a workable paint, the mixture is finely ground into a paste and combined with natural binders. The most critical component here is tamarind seed gum or resins gathered from local tree bark. These organic gums act as an adhesive fixative, ensuring the herbal pigment bonds flawlessly to the lacquered wooden surface without flaking off over time.

3. The Magical Transformation: Baking and Lacquering

The truly "magical" part of the process happens after the pigment is applied to the midnight-black or deep maroon canvas. Once the artisan paints the intricate jewelry, borders, and clothing patterns with this herbal-mineral mixture, the wooden panel is subjected to a careful warming or drying process.

Unlike conventional Indian folk arts executed on standard paper or canvas, authentic Nirmal Paintings are crafted entirely on lacquered wood. They serve as a brilliant visual chronicle of the Deccan's cultural identity, seamlessly weaving together local rural folklore, royal history, and profound mythological narratives.

Preserving a Threatened Legacy

Nirmal Art has faced significant challenges due to the decline of Poniki forests and the rise of inexpensive, mass-produced alternatives. To protect this centuries-old craft and the livelihoods of its artisans, Nirmal Paintings received the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag in 2008, ensuring that only authentic handcrafted works from the region can bear the Nirmal name.

Today, Nirmal Art is finding new life through state emporiums, designers, and modern collectors. Beyond traditional paintings, it now appears on furniture, corporate gifts, and decorative products, helping preserve a 400-year-old artistic legacy while bringing its timeless beauty to contemporary spaces. Its growing global recognition continues to create new opportunities for local artisans while ensuring this cherished craft is passed on to future generations.

THE AKSHAYA PATRA FOUNDATION

NOURISHING YOUNG MINDS, TRANSFORMING INDIA'S FUTURE

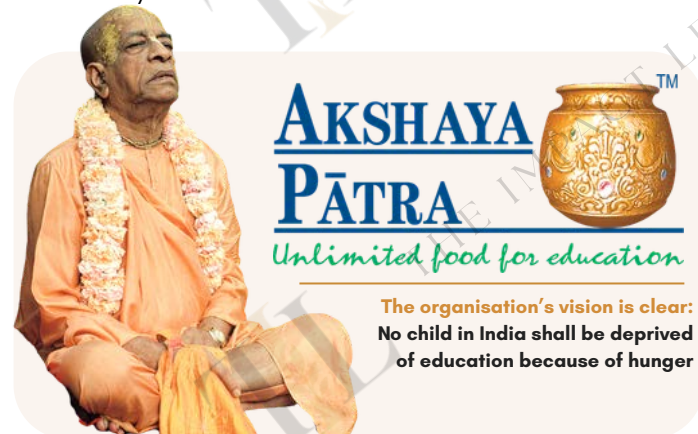
By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

In a country as vast and diverse as India, millions of children begin each school day carrying not only books but also the burden of hunger. For many, an empty stomach makes it difficult to concentrate, participate in class, or even attend school regularly. Recognizing this challenge, The Akshaya Patra Foundation emerged with a simple yet powerful belief: no child should be deprived of education because of hunger. Over the years, this belief has grown into one of the world's largest school meal programmes, transforming the lives of millions of children across the nation.

Established in the year 2000 and headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka, The Akshaya Patra Foundation is a non-profit charitable organization dedicated to addressing classroom hunger and malnutrition. Working in partnership with the Government of India under the PM POSHAN Scheme (formerly the Mid-Day Meal Scheme), the Foundation prepares and serves freshly cooked, nutritious meals to children studying in government and government-aided schools. What began as a small initiative serving just 1,500 students in five schools has today grown into a nationwide movement, reaching more than 2.35 million children every school day across 16 states and 3 Union Territories.

A Vision Born from Compassion

The inspiration behind The Akshaya Patra Foundation traces back to a deeply moving incident witnessed by A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, the founder of ISKCON. He once saw children struggling alongside stray dogs for scraps of food. The heartbreaking sight left a lasting impression and inspired the resolve that no child should have to suffer from hunger. This powerful vision of compassion and dignity became the driving force behind a nationwide mission to combat classroom hunger. Years later, this compassionate vision became the foundation upon which Akshaya Patra was established.



Nourishing Children. Empowering Dreams.

Akshaya Patra Foundation provides nutritious meals to children in government and government-aided schools, every single day.

- Nutritious Meals Every Day
- Encouraging Education and Attendance
- Supporting Health and Well-being
- Building a Better Tomorrow

Food for Education.
A Brighter Future.

The organization's vision "No child in India shall be deprived of education because of hunger" continues to guide every initiative it undertakes. It recognizes that education and nutrition go hand in hand. A nutritious meal not only satisfies hunger but also improves concentration, attendance, academic performance, and overall physical and mental well-being.

These numbers tell only part of the story. Behind every statistic is a family suddenly facing uncertainty, difficult medical decisions, emotional stress, and financial challenges. While some birth defects are visible immediately after delivery, many remain hidden and can only be identified through specialised screening.

Feeding Hope Every School Day

Every morning, before classrooms fill with eager students, Akshaya Patra's state-of-the-art kitchens come alive with activity. Large teams of trained staff prepare thousands of nutritious meals under strict hygiene standards using modern technology and efficient cooking systems. The meals are carefully designed to meet nutritional requirements while also respecting local food habits and cultural preferences. The Foundation's kitchens are among the most advanced in the world. Many of them are centralized, highly automated facilities capable of preparing tens of thousands of meals within a few hours. Sophisticated quality-control systems and streamlined logistics ensure that every meal reaches schools fresh, safe, and on time. This operational excellence enables the Foundation to serve millions of children consistently across diverse regions of the country.

In regions where centralized kitchens are not practical due to geography or distance, Akshaya Patra follows a decentralized kitchen model, working with local communities to prepare nutritious meals while maintaining the same standards of quality and hygiene. This flexibility enables the Foundation to serve children in both urban centres and remote rural areas with equal commitment.

Education Begins with Nutrition

The impact of The Akshaya Patra Foundation extends far beyond providing meals. Numerous schools have witnessed improved attendance, increased enrolment, reduced dropout rates, and better classroom participation after the introduction of regular nutritious lunches. For many children from economically disadvantaged families, the school meal may be the most balanced meal they receive in an entire day.

Parents are also encouraged to send their children to school knowing that they will receive healthy food in a safe environment. As a result, the programme contributes not only to better nutrition but also to stronger educational outcomes and brighter opportunities for future generations.

The Foundation's work directly supports several of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Zero Hunger (SDG 2) and Quality Education (SDG 4). By addressing hunger and promoting education simultaneously, Akshaya Patra demonstrates how one thoughtful initiative can create lasting social change.

Innovation Driving Social Impact

One of the defining strengths of The Akshaya Patra Foundation is its ability to combine compassion with innovation. The organization continuously adopts modern technology to improve efficiency, reduce food wastage, and maintain high standards of food safety.

Its advanced kitchen infrastructure, automated cooking systems, GPS-enabled delivery vehicles, quality control mechanisms, and data-driven logistics allow millions of meals to be delivered accurately and on time every school day. This blend of technology and humanitarian service has made Akshaya Patra a globally recognized model for large-scale social impact.

Beyond school lunches, the Foundation has also stepped forward during natural disasters, pandemics, and humanitarian emergencies by distributing food and relief supplies to affected communities. During the COVID-19 pandemic, for example, it provided millions of meals and grocery kits to vulnerable families, migrant workers, and many more. Its swift response during times of crisis reflects a deep commitment to serving those most in need with compassion and efficiency. By leveraging its extensive kitchen network and dedicated volunteers, the Foundation has been able to provide timely support while helping communities recover with dignity and hope.



Reaching Every Child

The Akshaya Patra Foundation continues to expand its reach through partnerships with governments, corporate organizations, philanthropic institutions, volunteers, and individual donors. Its public-private partnership model has become an example of how collaboration can successfully address large-scale social challenges.

The Foundation has also introduced initiatives such as morning nutrition programmes, recognizing that some children arrive at school without having breakfast. By providing healthy morning snacks alongside midday meals, it further strengthens children's nutrition and learning capacity. Recent programmes in Andhra Pradesh, including millet-based morning nutrition for students in Visakhapatnam, reflect this broader commitment to child well-being, with the programme being gradually expanded to other locations to reach more children in need.

A Future Filled with Possibilities

After more than two decades of dedicated service, The Akshaya Patra Foundation has become much more than a meal provider. Its remarkable journey from feeding just 1,500 children in Bengaluru to serving millions across India demonstrates the extraordinary impact that compassion, innovation, and collective responsibility can create. Its continued growth reflects the power of purpose-driven social impact. The Akshaya Patra Foundation stands as a shining example that when a nation nourishes its children, it nourishes its future.



VALLEY OF FLOWERS

NATURE'S LIVING MASTERPIECE IN THE HIMALAYAS

Hidden in the majestic Garhwal Himalayas of Uttarakhand, the Valley of Flowers National Park is one of India's most enchanting natural treasures. A UNESCO World Heritage Site, this breathtaking alpine valley is renowned for its vibrant meadows, rare Himalayan flora, and stunning mountain landscapes.

Every year, during July and August, the valley comes alive with a spectacular display of blooming wildflowers, attracting nature lovers, trekkers, botanists, photographers, and adventure enthusiasts from around the world.

Spread across approximately 87 square kilometres, the Valley of Flowers lies within the Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve at an altitude ranging from 3,200 to 3,600 metres above sea level.

Snow-covered for most of the year, the valley begins to awaken with the arrival of the monsoon. Rainfall nourishes the land, transforming it into a colourful paradise where thousands of flowers bloom against the backdrop of towering Himalayan peaks, crystal-clear streams, and lush green meadows.



The valley was brought to international attention in 1931 when British mountaineer Frank S. Smythe and his companions accidentally discovered it while returning from an expedition to Mount Kamet.

Mesmerised by its extraordinary beauty, Smythe later wrote the book *The Valley of Flowers*, introducing this hidden Himalayan gem to the world. Today, it is celebrated not only for its scenic splendour but also for its ecological importance.

During the flowering season, visitors can witness more than 500 species of alpine flowers, including blue poppies, primulas, orchids, anemones, marigolds, daisies, and Himalayan bellflowers.

Beyond its floral beauty, the Valley of Flowers supports a rich variety of wildlife. Although many animals remain hidden in the higher reaches of the Himalayas, the region provides a protected habitat for species such as the snow leopard, Himalayan musk deer, Himalayan black bear, blue sheep (bharal), and the colourful Himalayan monal, the state bird of Uttarakhand. The park's delicate ecosystem plays a vital role in conserving the biodiversity of the Western Himalayas.

Reaching the Valley of Flowers is an adventure in itself. Visitors begin their journey from Govindghat, followed by a scenic trek through Ghangaria, the base village for the national park.

QUICK FACTS

- Located in the Chamoli district of Uttarakhand, the Valley of Flowers is a world-renowned national park recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site since 2005. Spanning approximately 87 square kilometers, it sits at an elevation of 3,200 to 3,600 meters above sea level in the Western Himalayas.
- The region is celebrated for its breathtaking meadows of endemic alpine flowers and rich Himalayan biodiversity. During the bloom, hundreds of species transform the landscape into a vibrant carpet of colors.
- The optimal period to explore the valley is from mid-July to late August. During these monsoon months, the snow melts and rainfall triggers the full bloom of the alpine blossoms, bringing the entire region to life.
- Ghangaria serves as the primary base camp for treks into the Valley of Flowers. In addition to exploring the floral trails, visitors frequently combine their journey with a trek to the sacred high-altitude Sikh pilgrimage site, Hemkund Sahib. This unique blend of natural wonder and spiritual heritage draws adventurers and nature lovers from around the globe.



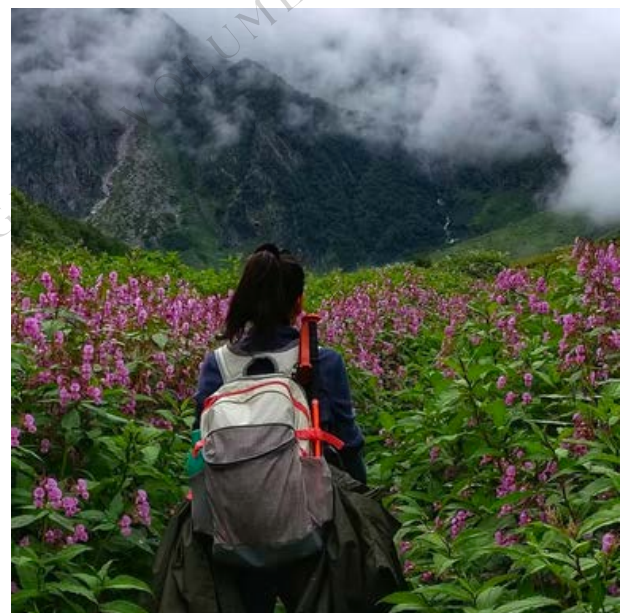
The final trek to the valley winds through forests, waterfalls, wooden bridges, and mountain streams, offering breathtaking views at every turn. While the trek requires moderate physical fitness, the reward is an unforgettable experience surrounded by nature's finest creations.

Just a few kilometres from Ghangaria lies Hemkund Sahib, a sacred Sikh pilgrimage site set beside a glacial lake at over 4,300 metres. Surrounded by snow-capped peaks, many travellers combine this spiritual shrine with their trip to the Valley of Flowers to experience both natural beauty and serenity.

The best time to visit is mid-July to late August, when peak blooms and pleasant weather make it a top monsoon destination. To preserve this fragile ecosystem, visitors should stay on designated trails, refrain from picking flowers, and avoid littering.

More than a tourist spot, the Valley of Flowers celebrates nature's resilience, beauty, and diversity. Whether you seek adventure, peace, or photography, it offers an unforgettable experience that lingers long after your journey ends.

The Valley of Flowers stands as one of India's most extraordinary natural wonders a place where the Himalayas bloom with life, colour, and hope every monsoon season. Its breathtaking landscapes and remarkable biodiversity continue to captivate nature lovers, researchers, and photographers from around the world, highlighting the importance of preserving fragile mountain ecosystems for future generations. It is a destination that inspires awe, encourages conservation, and reminds us of the timeless beauty of nature.



Bisleri bottles for change

Transforming Plastic Waste Into a Sustainable Future

Plastic waste is one of the world's biggest environmental challenges. Bisleri Bottles for Change is a nationwide movement that encourages responsible plastic waste management through awareness, education and community participation.

A Step Towards Responsible Plastic Management

Plastic waste has emerged as one of the most pressing environmental concerns across the world. Every year, millions of plastic bottles are discarded, many of which end up in landfills, rivers, and oceans, causing severe harm to the environment and wildlife. While plastic itself is a highly recyclable material, the real challenge lies in its improper disposal and lack of awareness about recycling. Recognizing this growing issue, Bisleri International launched Bottles for Change on World Environment Day, June 5, 2018, with the vision of promoting responsible plastic waste management and building a circular economy.

The initiative is not just a recycling campaign but a nationwide movement that encourages individuals, businesses, educational institutions, housing societies, and government organizations to rethink how they dispose of used plastic bottles. Through awareness, education, and community participation, Bisleri aims to ensure that every used plastic bottle is collected, recycled, and given a new life instead of becoming environmental waste.

The Vision Behind 'Bottles for Change'

The philosophy behind Bottles for Change is simple yet powerful: plastic is not waste it is a valuable resource when managed responsibly. The campaign encourages people to segregate plastic waste at the source and dispose of it through proper recycling channels. By educating communities about the importance of waste segregation and recycling, Bisleri is helping change public attitudes toward plastic and promoting sustainable living.

The programme actively collaborates with schools, colleges, corporate offices, hotels, restaurants, residential communities, airports, shopping malls, and public institutions to spread awareness about responsible waste management. Interactive workshops, awareness drives, recycling campaigns, and environmental education programmes have reached millions of people across India, inspiring them to become active participants in protecting the environment.

How the Initiative Works

The process begins with encouraging people to separate used plastic bottles from other household waste. Once collected, the bottles are handed over to authorized collection centres, waste management partners, and recycling agencies. These bottles are then cleaned, processed, and converted into recyclable plastic flakes, which are used to manufacture a wide range of useful products, including polyester fibres, clothing, bags, carpets, benches, construction materials, and various other non-food-grade products.

This recycling process not only prevents plastic from reaching landfills and water bodies but also reduces the demand for virgin plastic, conserves natural resources, and lowers carbon emissions. By supporting a circular economy, Bottles for Change demonstrates that plastic can be reused multiple times when managed responsibly. Through these collective efforts, it empowers every citizen to become an active contributor toward a cleaner, greener, and more sustainable planet for future generations.



Small actions today. Big impact tomorrow
Let's build a cleaner, greener and more sustainable India.



Creating a Lasting Environmental Impact

Since its launch, Bottles for Change has grown into one of India's leading plastic recycling awareness initiatives. The campaign has partnered with municipal corporations, environmental organizations, recyclers, and waste management companies to strengthen India's recycling ecosystem. It has successfully reached millions of citizens through awareness programmes and has helped channel thousands of metric tonnes of used plastic into responsible recycling systems.

Beyond recycling, the initiative emphasizes behavioural change. It encourages every individual to understand that protecting the environment begins with small daily actions, such as properly disposing of a used bottle or choosing to recycle instead of throwing it away. These simple habits collectively contribute to cleaner cities, healthier ecosystems, and a more sustainable future. Bisleri Bottles for Change is a remarkable example of how businesses can contribute to environmental conservation beyond their core operations. By transforming used plastic bottles into valuable resources and educating people about responsible waste management, the initiative is helping build a cleaner, greener, and more sustainable India.

The campaign reminds us that sustainability is a shared responsibility. Every bottle that is recycled instead of discarded is a step towards reducing pollution, conserving natural resources, and protecting future generations. Through Bottles for Change, Bisleri has shown that meaningful environmental change begins with one simple action choosing to recycle.

Empowering Communities for a Greener Tomorrow

Looking ahead, the movement continues to expand its reach across schools, corporate campuses, and residential complexes to turn environmental consciousness into a daily habit. By integrating ragpickers and waste collectors into a formalized, dignified recycling network, the initiative not only safeguards our ecosystems but also lifts up vulnerable livelihoods across urban India.

Ultimately, Bottles for Change proves that true sustainability goes beyond corporate policy it lives within our everyday choices. As more citizens embrace responsible waste segregation at home, this grassroots momentum is forging a resilient, circular economy where every recycled bottle brings the nation one step closer to a zero-waste future.

To make recycling accessible to all, the campaign has established streamlined collection models across major metros. By setting up designated drop-off points in residential complexes, educational institutions, and commercial hubs, Bottles for Change makes waste disposal more convenient. The collected plastic is then channelled through an organized recycling ecosystem.

Clean, dry plastics are systematically gathered, segregated by grade, and dispatched directly to certified recyclers, ensuring that materials stay within a controlled, closed-loop system rather than leaking into municipal landfills.

A vital yet often overlooked dimension of this initiative is its deep social impact on the informal waste management sector. By partnering with local ragpickers and waste collectors, Bottles for Change helps formalize their work, providing them with fair compensation, safer handling conditions, and professional dignity. This integration bridges the gap between marginalized waste workers and corporate supply chains, proving that effective environmental action can simultaneously drive social upliftment.

Education remains the primary engine driving the movement's long-term success. Through interactive workshops, street plays, and hands-on demonstrations in schools and colleges, the initiative instills eco-conscious habits in young minds from an early age. Students are taught to view discarded plastic not as garbage, but as a valuable resource that requires responsible handling. By transforming children into "sustainability ambassadors," the campaign successfully carries the message of waste segregation right into urban households.

Corporate participation has played a pivotal role by integrating segregated bins and awareness drives directly into commercial spaces, turning workplaces into active hubs for waste segregation. Simultaneously, Bottles for Change leverages digital platforms and mobile apps to offer real-time tracking, transparent data, and gamified engagement for urban residents. Ultimately, this powerful blend of corporate backing and tech-enabled civic action accelerates India's transition toward a circular economy, paving the way for a cleaner, greener, and more sustainable future.



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Inspired by the invisible power of fragrance and the resilience of the lotus, we create standard premium fragrances that help people express their individuality with confidence.

Every bottle is thoughtfully crafted to become a part of your journey, leaving a memorable presence wherever life takes you.



OUR MISSION

- 👤 Create fragrances that become a part of your identity.
- 👤 Express confidence through memorable fragrances.
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- 👤 Build lifelong relationships through trust and honesty.
- 👤 Inspire people to rise beyond ordinary and leave their presence.



OUR PHILOSOPHY

We believe your fragrance should never hide who you are. It should reveal your story.
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OUR VALUES

- 👤 Integrity in Every Promise
- 👤 Originality Over Imitation
- 👤 Quality Before Quantity
- 👤 Equal Respect for Every Customer
- 👤 Continuous Growth
- 👤 Honest Craftsmanship



OUR PROMISE

At Redolotus Ascend, every promise is backed by action. We promise genuine ingredients, consistent quality, honest communication, and fragrances that remain true to your individuality.

*You are the one people see.
We help them remember your presence.*



OUR CRAFTSMANSHIP

Great fragrances begin with genuine people. We carefully choose suppliers who value authenticity, quality, and ethical practices. Every ingredient is selected with care, every formulation is measured with precision, and every bottle is prepared under hygienic standards.

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INGREDIENTS

💧 SKIN-FRIENDLY
FORMULATIONS

🌸 AFFORDABLE
PREMIUM
EXPERIENCE

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ISHITA

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Defines the vision and purpose of Redolotus Ascend, leading brand strategy, product innovation, and long-term growth while ensuring every fragrance reflects the brand's identity and values.

CO-FOUNDER
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INDIA'S ECONOMY FACED PRESSURE FROM RISING OIL PRICES

Rising crude oil prices in July 2026 have created fresh economic challenges for India. As one of the world's largest oil-importing nations, the country remains focused on stability, growth, and a sustainable path toward energy security.



85%

IMPORTED
CRUDE OIL

India imports 85% of its crude oil needs.



16+

MAJOR
REFINERIES

Strengthening domestic capacity for energy security.



FOCUS

ENERGY
SECURITY

Diversifying sources to reduce dependence.



FUTURE

CLEAN ENERGY
TRANSITION

Investing in renewables for a sustainable tomorrow.

The global economy witnessed renewed uncertainty in July 2026 as crude oil prices continued to climb, creating fresh challenges for oil-importing nations. For India, which imports nearly 85% of its crude oil requirements, the increase in international oil prices became a significant economic concern. Rising fuel costs have the potential to affect inflation, transportation, manufacturing, and household expenses, making energy security one of the country's top priorities.

Despite these challenges, India demonstrated resilience by adopting a balanced economic approach. The government closely monitored global developments while reaffirming its commitment to maintaining economic stability, controlling inflation, and continuing investments in infrastructure and industrial growth. The developments of July highlighted the importance of reducing dependence on imported energy while accelerating the transition towards cleaner and more sustainable alternatives.

Why Oil Prices Matter

Crude oil plays a crucial role in every economy. It powers vehicles, industries, aviation, shipping, and electricity generation while serving as a key raw material for manufacturing sectors. When international crude oil prices rise, countries that rely heavily on imports must spend more on purchasing energy, increasing the overall cost of doing business. This often leads to higher transportation and production costs, which affect the prices of essential goods and services. Volatile oil prices also create uncertainty for businesses and policymakers, making planning more challenging. As a result, inflationary pressures increase, reducing consumer purchasing power and slowing overall economic growth.

For India, higher oil prices can lead to increased fuel costs, higher transportation charges, and rising prices of essential goods. Businesses often face higher production costs, while consumers may experience inflation as everyday commodities become more expensive. Therefore, fluctuations in global oil markets directly influence the country's economic performance.

Government's Response

Recognizing the potential impact of rising energy prices, the Government of India closely reviewed the situation throughout July. Economic policymakers emphasized the importance of protecting the country's fiscal stability while ensuring that growth momentum remained unaffected.

Alongside short-term measures to manage inflationary pressures, the government reiterated its focus on strengthening domestic manufacturing, expanding infrastructure, and encouraging investments in strategic sectors such as electronics, renewable energy, and semiconductor production. These initiatives are expected to improve India's long-term economic resilience and reduce dependence on external markets.

Balancing Growth and Inflation

One of the biggest challenges during periods of rising oil prices is maintaining a balance between economic growth and inflation. Higher fuel prices increase operational costs for businesses, which can eventually be reflected in the prices paid by consumers. This can reduce household spending, weaken consumer demand, and create additional pressure on policymakers to stabilize the economy while sustaining long-term growth.

Economists noted that careful financial planning, stable monetary policies, and continued investment in productive sectors would be essential to protecting India's growth trajectory. Despite global uncertainties, India's strong domestic demand, expanding industrial base, and growing digital economy continued to provide confidence to investors.

Towards Energy Security

The developments of July 2026 also strengthened discussions on India's long-term energy strategy. The country has been actively promoting renewable energy, electric mobility, green hydrogen, biofuels, and solar power to reduce dependence on imported fossil fuels. Large-scale investments in clean energy projects, along with initiatives.

Under the "Make in India" programme, are expected to improve energy security while supporting sustainable economic development. Experts believe that diversifying energy sources will help India better withstand future fluctuations in global oil markets.

In addition to expanding clean energy capacity, India is focusing on strengthening domestic energy infrastructure through improved oil storage facilities, modernized power grids, and increased investments in research and innovation. Public-private partnerships, policy reforms, and international collaborations are accelerating the adoption of sustainable technologies while encouraging greater energy efficiency across industries. These initiatives not only reduce vulnerability to external energy shocks but also create employment opportunities, attract investment, and contribute to the nation's broader vision of achieving energy self-reliance and environmental sustainability

Looking Ahead

Although rising crude oil prices created economic pressure during July 2026, India's response reflected confidence, preparedness, and long-term planning. Rather than allowing short-term challenges to slow development, the nation continued to focus on infrastructure expansion, industrial growth, technological innovation, and sustainable energy solutions. The events of July served as a reminder that global economic conditions can influence every nation, but resilience lies in strategic planning and responsible policymaking. Continued investments in renewable energy, domestic production, and energy-efficient technologies are expected to further strengthen India's economic resilience in the years ahead. As India moves towards becoming one of the world's leading economies, strengthening energy independence and maintaining economic stability will remain key priorities. With continued reforms, innovation, and prudent financial management, the country is well-positioned to overcome global challenges while sustaining its journey.



Looking ahead, India's economic future will depend on its ability to balance rapid development with fiscal discipline and sustainable resource management. Continued investments in renewable energy, digital infrastructure, advanced manufacturing, and research-driven innovation are expected to strengthen productivity while reducing dependence on external markets. By encouraging entrepreneurship, attracting global investments, and improving ease of doing business, India can build a more resilient and competitive economy capable of adapting to changing global conditions

At the same time, collaboration between the government, private sector, and citizens will play a vital role in ensuring long-term economic stability. Policies that promote energy conservation, efficient resource utilization, and technological advancement will help create a more self-reliant nation. Strengthening innovation, expanding renewable energy adoption, and encouraging responsible consumption will further support India's journey toward a secure and sustainable future. As global economies continue to evolve, India's commitment to sustainable growth, inclusive development, and strategic policymaking will enable it to transform challenges into opportunities and reinforce its position as a leading economic power on the world stage.





BRICS Summit

A Powerful Alliance Shaping the Future

By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

Introduction

The BRICS Summit is one of the world's most influential international gatherings, bringing together leading emerging economies to discuss global challenges and promote mutual cooperation. What began as an economic partnership among Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa has now grown into a broader alliance with the inclusion of Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, and Indonesia. Together, these nations represent nearly half of the world's population and a significant share of the global economy, making BRICS a powerful voice in international affairs.

Purpose of the BRICS Summit

The primary objective of the BRICS Summit is to strengthen cooperation among member nations in areas such as trade, investment, technology, infrastructure, healthcare, education, climate action, and sustainable development. The summit provides a platform for leaders to exchange ideas, discuss global economic issues, and work together to create solutions that benefit both developing and emerging economies.

In addition to economic cooperation, BRICS promotes a more balanced and inclusive global governance system by encouraging greater representation of developing countries in international financial and political institutions.

India's Significant Role

India has been a founding member of BRICS and continues to play a key role in shaping the group's vision. The country actively promotes inclusive economic growth, digital transformation, renewable energy, innovation, and sustainable infrastructure. India's success in digital public services, financial inclusion, and technological advancement has become an important model for collaboration among BRICS nations.

Through its leadership, India has consistently emphasized the importance of strengthening partnerships among developing countries while addressing global challenges such as climate change, food security, public health, and energy sustainability.

Highlights of the 2025 BRICS Summit

The 17th BRICS Summit, held in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, in July 2025, focused on expanding economic cooperation among member nations. Leaders discussed increasing trade using local currencies, strengthening investment opportunities, improving digital connectivity, promoting artificial intelligence, and supporting sustainable development initiatives.

Climate action, healthcare cooperation, clean energy, food security, and innovation remained major areas of discussion. The summit also highlighted the need for stronger multilateral cooperation and peaceful dialogue to address global economic uncertainties and regional challenges.

Another important focus was enhancing collaboration in science, technology, education, and infrastructure development to create long-term economic resilience and shared prosperity.





The New Development Bank

One of the greatest achievements of BRICS is the establishment of the New Development Bank (NDB) in 2015. The bank provides financial support for infrastructure and sustainable development projects in member countries and other developing economies. By investing in sectors such as renewable energy, transportation, water management, urban development, and clean technology, the NDB contributes significantly to economic growth while promoting environmentally responsible development.

Global Importance of BRICS

Today, BRICS has become one of the most influential economic alliances in the world. Its member nations possess vast natural resources, large consumer markets, advanced manufacturing capabilities, and rapidly growing technology sectors. The expanded membership has further strengthened the group's global influence and created new opportunities for trade, investment, and innovation.



As developing nations continue to play a larger role in the global economy, BRICS serves as a vital platform for promoting cooperation and encouraging sustainable development. By pooling resources and expanding intra-bloc trade, member countries accelerate local industries while insulating themselves against market volatility. Joint investments in green energy and modern infrastructure ensure this economic momentum remains resilient for the future. Through this unified framework, the alliance guarantees that emerging economies have a stronger voice in international decision-making. Ultimately, this collective advocacy fosters a multi-polar world order by empowering developing nations to shape global governance.



The BRICS Summit represents far more than an annual diplomatic meeting; it stands as a symbol of collaboration, shared progress, and collective responsibility among some of the world's fastest-growing economies. By strengthening economic partnerships, encouraging innovation, supporting sustainable development, and promoting inclusive governance, BRICS continues to shape the future of international cooperation. As the alliance expands and evolves, it deepens trade and financial integration to foster equitable growth. Ultimately, BRICS remains committed to addressing global inequalities and building a more balanced, resilient, and prosperous world for future generations.

"In a world of complex global challenges, no single nation can progress in isolation; true stability and prosperity emerge when developing economies unite to build a fair, inclusive, and cooperative international order."

The EPIC SUNSET

VOLUME 1 | JULY 2026

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“

*Every sunset
is proof that
endings are never
the end, they are
quiet beginnings
waiting for tomorrow.*



As the sun meets the horizon, the sky reminds us that everyday leaves behind a story worth remembering and a hope worth pursuing.

 Photography:© Srinath

CHAMPIONING CONSERVATION: VATA FOUNDATION'S VISION FOR A GREENER TOMORROW

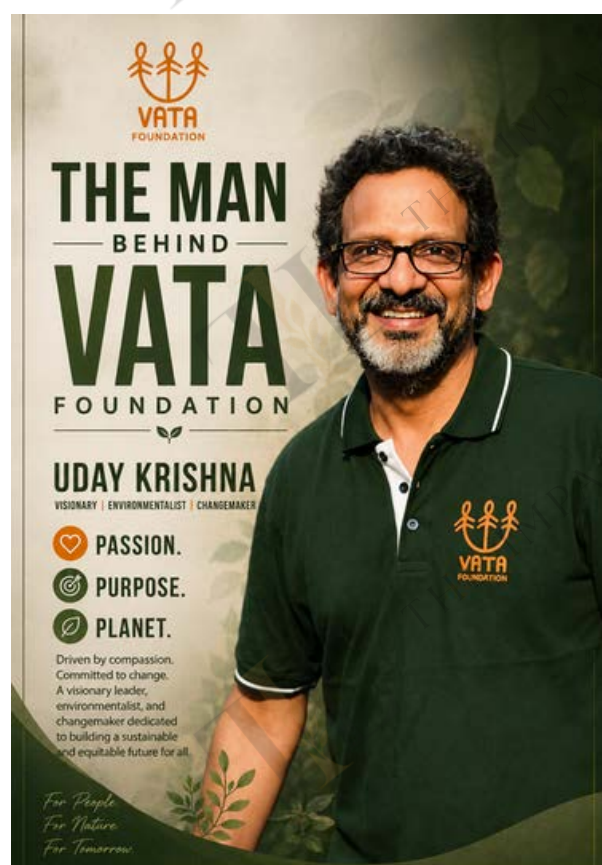
As cities continue to grow and infrastructure projects become a part of everyday life, the need to protect the environment has never been greater. While development is essential, it often comes at the cost of losing thousands of mature trees that have taken decades to grow. Recognizing this challenge, VATA Foundation has emerged as one of India's leading environmental organizations, proving that progress and nature can exist together.

Founded in 2015 by Uday Krishna Peddireddi and Jyoti Konda, VATA Foundation is a Hyderabad-based non-profit organization dedicated to conserving trees, restoring green spaces, protecting forests, and promoting sustainable development. The Foundation was established with a simple yet powerful belief that every mature tree is valuable and deserves a chance to live.

The idea behind VATA Foundation was born during an infrastructure project in Hyderabad. While working on a construction project, founder Uday Krishna Peddireddi faced the challenge of several large trees standing in the project's path. Instead of allowing them to be cut down, he explored the possibility of relocating them safely.

The Beginning of an Inspiring Journey

Through careful planning and scientific techniques, the trees were successfully transplanted to a new location, where most survived and continued to grow. This remarkable achievement demonstrated that development does not have to mean destroying nature. Inspired by this success, VATA Foundation was created to promote tree conservation and sustainable development. One of the Foundation's most significant contributions is its expertise in tree translocation the scientific process of relocating fully grown trees from one place to another. Unlike planting new saplings, saving mature trees helps preserve decades of ecological benefits, including cleaner air, shade, biodiversity, and carbon absorption.



Giving Trees a Second Life

Beyond tree relocation, VATA Foundation actively works towards afforestation, biodiversity conservation, and ecosystem restoration. The Foundation plants native and diverse species, restores degraded landscapes, and collaborates with schools, corporate partners, government departments, and local communities to create long-term environmental impact.

Through initiatives such as the Big Tree Quest, which documents ecologically and historically significant heritage trees, VATA Foundation continues to create awareness about the importance of protecting natural resources and preserving India's green heritage.

Restoring Forests, Protecting Wildlife, and Building Sustainable Ecosystems

One of VATA Foundation's most significant conservation initiatives is its partnership with the Maharashtra Forest Department since 2015 to strengthen forest ecosystems. The Foundation has adopted two wildlife landscapes Tipeswar Wildlife Sanctuary (140+ sq. km) and Penganga Wildlife Sanctuary (400 sq. km) with the vision of transforming degraded forests into self-sustaining ecosystems. At Tipeswar, VATA Foundation has contributed through native plantations, water conservation projects, wildlife habitat improvement, and community-based initiatives. Building on this success, the Foundation is now working towards restoring Penganga Wildlife Sanctuary through ecological restoration and sustainable conservation practices.

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BONALU 2026: TELANGANA'S VIBRANT FESTIVAL OF FAITH, GRATITUDE, AND CULTURE

By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

A Celebration Rooted in Devotion

Every year, during the sacred Hindu month of Ashadha, which falls in July, Telangana celebrates Bonalu, one of its most cherished cultural and religious festivals. Dedicated to Goddess Mahakali, the festival is an expression of gratitude for her blessings and protection from diseases, hardships, and negative forces. In July 2026, thousands of devotees from Hyderabad, Secunderabad, and various districts of Telangana gathered at temples to offer prayers and participate in the grand celebrations with unwavering faith and enthusiasm.

The Sacred Offering of Bonam

The word "Bonam" means "meal" or "offering" in Telugu and symbolises thanksgiving to the Goddess. Women prepare a special offering of cooked rice, jaggery, milk, and curd in beautifully decorated earthen or brass pots adorned with neem leaves, turmeric, vermilion, and a lit lamp. Carrying these sacred offerings on their heads, they walk in colourful processions to Mahakali temples while singing devotional songs and seeking blessings for the health, prosperity, and well-being of their families.

A Tradition with a Rich History

Bonalu has a history spanning more than two centuries. According to popular belief, the festival originated when people prayed to Goddess Mahakali during a deadly epidemic, promising to offer Bonam if their community was protected. After the epidemic subsided, devotees fulfilled their promise, and the tradition has continued ever since. Today, Bonalu stands as a symbol of faith, gratitude, and Telangana's enduring cultural heritage.

Over the centuries, the festival has evolved into a grand, vibrant celebration that unites communities across Hyderabad, Secunderabad, and the rest of Telangana. Rows of women dressed in colorful traditional attire carry decorated clay pots, balanced effortlessly on their heads, while the thunderous beats of the Potharajus the fiercely painted guardians of the Goddess fill the streets with raw energy. The festival also showcases Telangana's rich cultural identity, with traditional music, dance, and age-old customs being proudly passed down from one generation to the next. More than just a religious ritual, Bonalu is a triumph of collective devotion and artistic heritage, filling the air with folk songs, lavish processions, and an unforgettable sense of unity.



Colourful Rituals and Cultural Significance

One of the most striking attractions of Bonalu is Pothuraju, regarded as the guardian and brother of Goddess Mahakali. Dressed in vibrant attire and adorned with turmeric, he leads the temple processions with energetic dances that symbolise strength, courage, and protection. Another important ritual is the Rangam, during which a woman believed to be blessed by the Goddess delivers blessings and predictions for the community. Traditional drum performances, folk dances, and devotional music add to the vibrant atmosphere, making Bonalu a unique blend of spirituality and cultural celebration.

Beyond the energetic presence of Pothuraju and the solemnity of the Rangam, the preparation and offering of the Bonam itself is a deeply sacred ritual that showcases the artistic devotion of Telangana's women. Beginning at dawn, women cook a traditional dish of rice, jaggery, milk, and curd in new earthen or brass pots. These pots are carefully adorned with turmeric paste, vermilion, and fresh neem leaves elements revered for their purifying and medicinal properties. With a lit oil lamp (diya) balanced atop the decorated pot, hundreds of women walk together in disciplined, colorful processions toward the temples, carrying their feast as a personal token of gratitude and prayer for their family's well-being.

The month-long celebrations reach their majestic climax during the Ghatam procession, which marks the farewell journey of the Goddess. A sacred copper pot, intricately decorated to represent Goddess Mahakali, is carried on the head of a priest smeared in turmeric and accompanied by traditional teenmar drum ensembles. In the Old City of Hyderabad, the procession traditionally features the Ghatam mounted on a decorated elephant, winding its way past historic landmarks like the Charminar.



Bonalu 2026: Preserving Telangana's Heritage

During Bonalu 2026, the twin cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad came alive with unmatched spiritual fervor as major temples, including the Sri Ujjaini Mahakali Temple in Secunderabad and the Sri Simhavahini Mahakali Temple at Lal Darwaza, witnessed an overwhelming turnout of devotees. From dawn to dusk, the air resounded with the rhythmic beats of teenmar drums, devotional hymns, and joyous folk songs. Millions of pilgrims gathered to express their heartfelt gratitude to Goddess Mahakali, turning the historic streets into a sea of vibrant colors, traditional attire, and sacred offerings. Long queues stretching for miles reflected the deep-seated faith of families who traveled from remote districts to offer their prayers. The majestic sight of women balancing decorated earthen pots adorned with neem leaves added an ethereal beauty to the bustling metropolis. Every corner of the twin cities radiated a unique blend of ancient tradition and infectious festive enthusiasm.

To accommodate the unprecedented rush of visitors, the Telangana Government made elaborate, state-of-the-art arrangements across all festival zones. Special focus was placed on security, traffic management, sanitation, and round-the-clock medical facilities to ensure the smooth, safe conduct of the month-long event. Free drinking water kiosks, dedicated queue lines for women carrying Bonam pots, and extensive CCTV surveillance helped create a seamless and comfortable environment for families, senior citizens, and tourists alike. Additionally, special RTC bus services were deployed to facilitate smooth transport for thousands of devotees arriving from rural regions. The state electricity board ensured uninterrupted power supply, illuminating historic temples with spectacular decorative lighting that dazzled night-time visitors. Civil defense volunteers working hand-in-hand with local police personnel earned widespread praise for their efficient crowd management.

More than a religious observance, Bonalu serves as a powerful symbol of Telangana's rich cultural identity, reflecting the enduring values of unity, devotion, and community solidarity. The festival seamlessly weaves together sacred rituals such as the fierce dance of Pothuraju, the prophetic oracle of Rangam, and the grand Ghatam processions with the artistic folk traditions of the region. It stands as a living testament to how ancient cultural expressions continue to flourish and inspire in a modern metropolis. Local artisans, performers, and street vendors also found vibrant livelihoods during the month-long festivities, boosting the local economy. Neighborhood communities actively came together across religious and social lines to organize annadanam (food distribution) for pilgrims, highlighting the compassionate spirit of the city. This harmonious atmosphere reinforced Bonalu's status as a quintessential celebration of collective heritage and mutual respect.

The grand celebrations of July 2026 once again demonstrated that while society continues to evolve rapidly, traditions deeply rooted in faith remain timeless. By bridging generations and bringing people together across all walks of life, Bonalu preserves the soulful heritage of Telangana. As the festivities drew to a close, they left behind a renewed sense of pride, communal harmony, and a vibrant cultural legacy that will continue to shine for generations to come. Younger generations actively participated in digital storytelling and cultural photography, capturing the spirit of the festival for global audiences. The ceremonial immersion of the Ghatams served as a poignant reminder of life's continuous cycle and the eternal promise of divine protection. Ultimately, Bonalu 2026 re-anchored the state's cultural roots while paving a hopeful path toward a unified and prosperous future.

“ FESTIVALS ARE THE COLORS OF LIFE. THEY BRING JOY, SHARED TRADITIONS, AND PEOPLE TOGETHER. ”



GARCINIA GUMMI-GUTTA: NATURE'S TANGY TREASURE WITH TIMELESS VALUE

By The Impact Ledger | Food bureau | July 2026

"The greatest gifts of nature are often hidden in the simplest forms. Garcinia gummi-gutta is one such treasure, enriching food, preserving tradition, and inspiring wellness across generations."

Nestled within the lush evergreen forests of India's Western Ghats grows Garcinia gummi-gutta, popularly known as Malabar Tamarind and affectionately called Kudampuli in Kerala.

Although many people refer to it as a spice, it is actually the sun-dried rind of a tropical fruit that has been an integral part of South Indian kitchens for centuries. Its distinctive tangy flavour has enhanced countless traditional recipes while also serving as a natural preservative, especially in seafood dishes long before refrigeration became common.

For generations, families have treasured this humble fruit, passing down recipes and traditional knowledge from one generation to the next. Its continued relevance reflects the enduring value of traditional wisdom in modern lifestyles. Today, Garcinia gummi gutta is appreciated not only for its culinary importance but also as a symbol of India's rich biodiversity, cultural heritage, and enduring food traditions.



Nature's Remarkable Creation

Garcinia gummi-gutta belongs to the Clusiaceae family and grows as a hardy evergreen tree in tropical climates. It produces bright golden-yellow, pumpkin-shaped fruits with deep grooves that make them instantly recognizable. After harvesting, the thick outer rind is separated, lightly salted, and carefully dried under the sun. This traditional process transforms the rind into its familiar dark brown colour while concentrating its pleasantly tangy flavour.



The tree thrives naturally in Kerala, Karnataka, Goa, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, and several neighbouring countries, where warm temperatures, abundant rainfall, and fertile soils provide ideal growing conditions. Once established, Garcinia trees remain productive for decades, making them valuable assets for farming communities and an important part of the region's ecological landscape.

A Sustainable Crop for the Future

One of *Garcinia gummi-gutta*'s greatest strengths is its compatibility with sustainable agriculture. It grows well alongside coconut, arecanut, pepper, banana, and other fruit trees, making it an excellent component of mixed farming systems. The trees require relatively little chemical intervention, help improve soil health, reduce erosion, conserve biodiversity, and provide shelter for birds and other wildlife.

For many rural families, *Garcinia* cultivation is more than farming it is a tradition that supports livelihoods while protecting the environment. Its long lifespan, resilience, and low-maintenance nature make it an increasingly valuable crop in a world that is placing greater emphasis on environmentally responsible agriculture.

Small Fruit, Rich Nutrition

Although consumed in small quantities, *Garcinia gummi-gutta* contains a variety of beneficial nutrients and naturally occurring plant compounds, including dietary fibre, vitamin C, calcium, potassium, magnesium, antioxidants, flavonoids, and polyphenols. It is especially known for Hydroxycitric Acid (HCA), a naturally occurring compound that has attracted global scientific interest.

Researchers have explored HCA for its potential role in regulating appetite and supporting healthy fat metabolism. While some studies suggest it may contribute to healthy weight management when combined with a balanced diet and regular physical activity, scientific findings remain mixed. As a result, experts recommend viewing *Garcinia* as one component of a healthy lifestyle rather than a miracle solution. Ongoing research continues to investigate its wider health benefits, including its antioxidant, digestive, and metabolic properties.



A Timeless Culinary Delight

The true magic of *Garcinia gummi-gutta* lies in its extraordinary flavour. Unlike tamarind or lemon, it imparts a gentle, smoky tanginess that blends beautifully with other ingredients rather than overpowering them. It is best known as the signature ingredient in Kerala's famous fish curries, where it enhances the richness of seafood while adding depth, balance, and its distinctive tangy character.

Beyond fish curries, the dried rind is widely used in vegetable stews, lentil preparations, coconut gravies, meat dishes, pickles, and traditional chutneys. Before cooking, it is usually soaked in warm water, allowing its concentrated flavour to infuse gradually into the dish. This unique taste has made *Garcinia* an irreplaceable ingredient in South Indian cuisine, where it continues to connect generations through cherished family recipes and regional culinary traditions.

From Tradition to Global Recognition

For centuries, *Garcinia gummi-gutta* has been valued in Ayurvedic traditions for supporting digestion and overall well-being, and today it continues to attract global interest for its role in plant-based nutrition and natural products. While healthcare professionals recommend using it as part of a balanced diet rather than as a medical treatment, the growing international demand for its dried rind and extracts has expanded export opportunities, creating additional income for farming communities and highlighting the importance of sustainable cultivation and responsible harvesting.

A Legacy Worth Preserving

Garcinia gummi-gutta is far more than a culinary ingredient. It represents the harmonious relationship between nature, tradition, and science. From the forests of the Western Ghats to kitchens around the world, it continues to enrich meals, support rural livelihoods, and inspire ongoing scientific discovery. As the world increasingly embraces natural foods and sustainable living, *Garcinia gummi-gutta* reminds us that some of nature's greatest treasures have quietly enriched lives for centuries. Preserving this remarkable fruit and the traditions surrounding it will ensure that future generations continue to benefit from one of India's finest botanical gifts while celebrating its enduring legacy.





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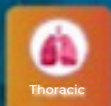
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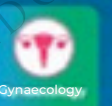
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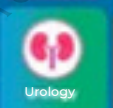
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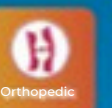
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WHERE MILLIMETERS BECOME MASTERPIECES: THE WORLD OF MICRO ARTIST NITHIN

By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

The Beginning of a Passion

The smaller the canvas, the greater the patience it demands. In a world where art is often defined by scale and grandeur, Micro Artist Nithin has carved a unique identity by working in spaces almost invisible to the naked eye. A self-taught micro artist with over nine years of experience, Micro Artist Nithin's journey is a powerful story of passion, patience, and persistence proving that even the smallest creations can leave the biggest impact.

Micro Artist Nithin began his artistic journey in June 2017, sparked by a simple yet profound moment. Watching a friend attempt chalk carvings inspired by a television show ignited his curiosity. With no formal training or access to professional tools, Micro Artist Nithin started experimenting using everyday objects like a toothpick and a safety pin. What began as a casual attempt soon transformed into a disciplined practice, driven by curiosity and determination.

Exploring Creativity Without Limits

Deeply curious by nature, Micro Artist Nithin has always been driven to explore different art forms and push creative boundaries. His artistic expertise spans across pencil carvings, chalk carvings, food miniatures, scale models, functional miniature furniture, miniature dioramas, paper quilling, digital art, photography, 3D modelling, sculpting, string art, book folding art, and wire art. This constant exploration defines his creative identity.

From Chalk to Graphite Precision

His early works involved carving letters on chalk, which gradually evolved into more detailed sculptures. Through consistent practice and self-learning by observing artists and exploring online resources, Micro Artist Nithin discovered advanced tools and materials. The introduction to 10B graphite pencils, known for their softer and thicker leads, marked a turning point in his journey. This phase helped him refine his precision and develop the confidence to attempt increasingly complex creations.

Transitioning from chalk to pencil lead was both challenging and transformative. Micro art demands extraordinary control; even the slightest miscalculation can break the delicate graphite and erase hours of effort. Yet, Micro Artist Nithin embraced these challenges, turning failures into stepping stones. Each completed artwork strengthened his skills and reinforced his determination to push the boundaries of miniature craftsmanship.

A Record Carved in Determination

On July 25, 2019, after months of relentless practice and hundreds of failed attempts, Micro Artist Nithin achieved a remarkable milestone. He carved the entire alphabet (A-Z) on both sides of a 0.7 mm graphite lead within just seven hours, earning recognition from the Vajra Book of World Records. This achievement stands as a testament to his patience, focus, and unwavering dedication.

Expanding Artistic Horizons

Over the years, Micro Artist Nithin has expanded his artistic repertoire far beyond pencil lead carving. His work includes miniature food art, miniature dioramas, custom micro lettering, book folding art, miniature furniture, paper miniatures, paper quilling, and photography. In 2021, inspired by food miniature creations on Instagram, he independently explored and mastered the craft, further strengthening his self-taught journey. His passion for continuous learning has enabled him to diversify his artistic expression.

Operating under his personal brand MAN (Micro Artist Nithin) and MAN Crafts, he creates customized artistic gifts that combine creativity with emotion. Each piece reflects a story, transforming simple materials into meaningful miniature worlds. His personalized creations have earned appreciation for their originality, craftsmanship, and attention to detail.



About the Artist:

Micro Artist Nithin is a self-taught artist specializing in micro art and miniature creations, with over nine years of experience. Founder of MAN (Micro Artist Nithin) and MAN Crafts, he is known for his world-record pencil lead carving and diverse artistic skills across multiple art forms. His works have been exhibited at national institutions and global platforms like TEDx, and featured in Telugu newspapers. Through his art and workshops, he continues to inspire creativity and perseverance.



Signature Creations

Among his most celebrated works are an intricately carved astronaut on pencil lead, the A-Z dual-side graphite carving, over 15 realistic miniature musical instruments made entirely from colored paper, functional miniature furniture, a small-scale coffee house setup, and lifelike food miniatures. Notably, Micro Artist Nithin achieves all of this without using microscopes, relying purely on his precision and control.

Recognition and Influence

Micro Artist Nithin's work has been showcased at prestigious institutions such as NIT Rourkela and IIIT Kurnool, as well as influential platforms including TEDx Hyderabad and TEDx Anurag University. He has also conducted workshops on micro art, inspiring others to explore this intricate field. His journey and creations have been featured in multiple Telugu newspapers, further amplifying his recognition.

Beyond exhibitions and workshops, Nithin's art has inspired students, aspiring artists, and creative enthusiasts to appreciate the beauty of precision and perseverance. His ability to transform ordinary materials into extraordinary masterpieces has earned him admiration from educators, professionals, and art lovers alike. Through every exhibition and public interaction, he continues to promote micro art as a unique discipline that celebrates patience, innovation, and limitless creativity, leaving a lasting impact on everyone who experiences his work.

The Art of Patience

Micro art is one of the most delicate forms of artistic expression. It demands immense patience, concentration, and dedication. A single mistake can destroy hours of work, and fragile materials like graphite often break during the process. Micro Artist Nithin is currently working on a challenging piece for the past four years one that has broken more than 200 times, yet his determination remains unshaken. His journey exemplifies how passion and perseverance can transform even the smallest creations into extraordinary works of art. For Nithin, every broken pencil tip or failed attempt is not a setback but a lesson in resilience. His unwavering commitment reflects the true spirit of an artist who believes that perfection is achieved through persistence rather than speed.

Each masterpiece is the result of countless hours of careful craftsmanship, proving that extraordinary achievements are built on discipline, focus, and an unrelenting passion for excellence. His journey stands as a powerful reminder that patience itself is an art form, capable of turning the smallest creations into the greatest inspirations.

Recognition and Publications

Micro Artist Nithin's artistic journey has not gone unnoticed. His works, creative insights, and unique approach to art have been featured in multiple Telugu newspapers, bringing his talent to a wider audience and earning him recognition within the artistic community. These publications stand as a testament to his growing influence and the impact of his work, inspiring others to explore unconventional art forms.

"In micro art, one small mistake can break hours of work but patience rebuilds it stronger every time."

For Micro Artist Nithin, art is not defined by size but by the depth of passion behind it. His journey is a reminder that with consistency, curiosity, and resilience, even the smallest creations can carry the most powerful stories. Each creation reflects his dedication to detail and his passion for turning the ordinary into something extraordinary.



INDIA'S MONSOON CHALLENGE

WHEN THE RAINS TURN RELENTLESS

For millions of Indians, the arrival of the monsoon is a season of hope. It replenishes rivers, fills reservoirs, nourishes crops, and breathes new life into the land after the scorching summer months. However, July 2026 presented a different reality. What began as a welcome spell of rain soon transformed into a period of destruction, leaving thousands of families struggling against floods, landslides, and widespread disruption. Several states experienced exceptionally heavy rainfall, reminding the nation that while the monsoon is essential for India's economy, it can also become one of its greatest natural challenges.

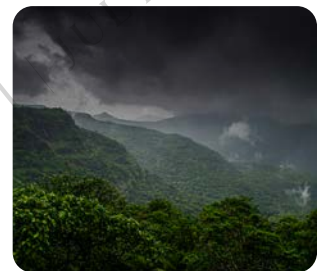
Among the worst affected regions was Wayanad in Kerala, where torrential rains triggered fresh landslides in vulnerable hilly areas. The tragedy once again highlighted the growing concerns surrounding climate change, environmental degradation, and the increasing frequency of extreme weather events.

A Monsoon That Tested the Nation

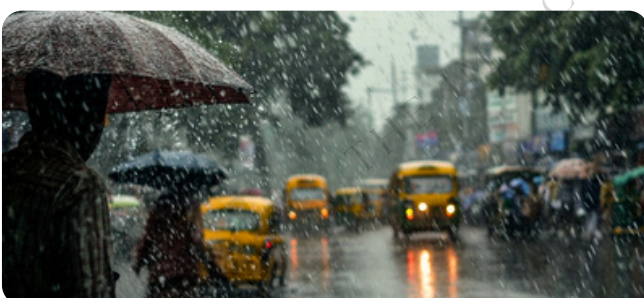
Throughout July, heavy rainfall affected many parts of the country, including Kerala, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Assam, and several northeastern states. Rivers overflowed, roads disappeared under floodwaters, railway services were disrupted, and thousands of people were forced to leave their homes for safer locations. The relentless downpours also caused widespread damage to homes, agricultural lands, public infrastructure, and essential services, affecting the daily lives of millions of people.

While India's monsoon is vital for replenishing water reservoirs and driving agricultural life, its increasingly relentless downpours bring severe urban flooding, landslides, and widespread disruption. Balancing the life giving necessity of seasonal rains with the rising threat of extreme, climate-driven weather remains one of the nation's most pressing challenges.

WHERE THE RAINS UNVEIL NATURE'S SECRETS



Rescue teams from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), State Disaster Response Forces, the Indian Army, Navy, Air Force, and local authorities worked tirelessly to evacuate stranded residents. Relief camps were established to provide food, drinking water, medical assistance, and temporary shelter to affected families. Essential services such as electricity, communication networks, and road connectivity were gradually restored to ensure relief operations reached even the most affected areas. Despite the difficult conditions, countless volunteers, social organizations, and local communities came together to help those in need, demonstrating the remarkable spirit of compassion that often emerges during times of crisis.



THE WAYANAD TRAGEDY

The picturesque district of Wayanad, known for its lush green hills, coffee plantations, and tourism, once again became the centre of national attention due to devastating landslides triggered by continuous rainfall.

Entire stretches of land gave way within minutes, damaging homes, roads, and public infrastructure. Rescue personnel worked day and night under extremely dangerous conditions to search for survivors and provide assistance to affected families.

The incident renewed discussions among scientists and environmental experts regarding construction activities in ecologically sensitive regions. Many experts stressed that unplanned development, deforestation, and changes in land use have increased the vulnerability of hill regions to landslides. The tragedy served as a painful reminder that development must always be balanced with environmental conservation.

A Monsoon That Tested the Nation

While excessive rainfall created problems in some regions, many farmers also benefited from improved water availability for agriculture. Reservoirs filled rapidly, groundwater levels improved, and crop sowing accelerated in several states.



However, in flood-affected areas, standing crops suffered severe damage. Rice fields, vegetable farms, fruit orchards, and plantations were submerged, leading to significant financial losses for farming communities.

Livestock was also affected, and transportation disruptions made it difficult for farmers to reach markets. For many rural families, the monsoon became both a blessing and a challenge, highlighting the delicate balance between agriculture and nature.

Cities Under Pressure

Heavy rainfall in July exposed severe weaknesses in urban drainage systems, causing widespread waterlogging and submerged roads across several Indian cities. The resulting chaos delayed public transport and disrupted local businesses, underscoring an urgent need for upgraded infrastructure and climate-resilient development.

Climate Change and the New Reality

Scientists increasingly believe that climate change is contributing to more frequent and intense weather events around the world. Rising global temperatures allow the atmosphere to hold more moisture, resulting in heavier rainfall during monsoon periods.

India has witnessed a noticeable increase in extreme weather events over the past decade, including floods, heatwaves, cyclones, and landslides. Environmental experts argue that strengthening disaster preparedness, improving early warning systems, and protecting forests and wetlands are essential steps in reducing future risks.

Communities also have an important role to play by promoting sustainable development, protecting natural ecosystems, and supporting responsible land-use practices.

THE LESSONS FOR THE FUTURE

The monsoon of July 2026 highlighted both the power of nature and the resilience of the Indian people. Nature continues to remind us of the critical importance of preparedness and environmental stewardship. Governments at both the central and state levels have emphasized the need to invest in stronger infrastructure, better flood management systems, and sustainable development practices. At the same time, awareness among citizens regarding disaster preparedness has become more important than ever.

The events of July 2026 will be remembered for the extraordinary courage shown by rescue workers, volunteers, healthcare professionals, and ordinary citizens who stood together in the face of adversity. Their tireless efforts on the ground proved that a nation's greatest strength lies in its collective empathy during times of crisis. As India continues its journey towards growth, the lessons from this monsoon underline an important truth: true progress is achieved not only by building stronger cities, but by protecting the environment that sustains them. The rains may test the nation's resilience, but they also inspire unity, compassion, and the determination to build a safer.



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Butterfly Charitable Trust: Transforming Lives Through Compassion and Hope

By The Impact Ledger | July 2026

Across India, countless communities continue to struggle with poverty, lack of education, inadequate healthcare, and limited access to basic infrastructure. While these challenges often go unnoticed, organisations like Butterfly Charitable Trust (BCT) are working tirelessly to bring meaningful change where it is needed the most.

Established in 2024, Butterfly Charitable Trust is a non-profit organisation committed to building a compassionate society where every individual lives with dignity, respect, and equal opportunity. Guided by the theme "Transforming Lives," the Trust works in the areas of education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and community development, reaching vulnerable children, tribal communities, elderly people, and families living in extreme need.

The Trust believes that real transformation begins at the grassroots. Its mission is not simply to provide temporary relief but to empower communities with opportunities that create lasting change.

Creating Change Where It Matters Most

One of the Trust's remarkable initiatives is its work in Poolakomma Vagu, a remote tribal village in Mulugu district. Recognising the lack of educational opportunities for the Gutthi Koya tribal community, Butterfly Charitable Trust established a Tribal Bridge School that provides a safe learning environment, local teachers, and educational support for children facing barriers to education.



The Trust also supports students through scholarships, library development, distribution of stationery and examination kits, and recreational activities that encourage holistic growth.



Lighting Up Forgotten Villages

Another milestone initiative is Project Roshni, launched to bring electricity to villages that had remained in darkness for decades. Through the installation of solar-powered lighting systems, Butterfly Charitable Trust illuminated 42 tribal households, improving safety, children's education, and overall quality of life. For many villagers, it was the first time they had experienced electric light inside their homes.

Extending Care Beyond Education

The Trust's commitment extends well beyond schools.

Its healthcare initiatives include distributing medicines, nutrition support, hygiene kits, food supplies, and essential care materials to old-age homes, recovery shelters, vulnerable women, children, and homeless communities across Hyderabad. It also works to strengthen families through Project Sahayatha, promoting dignity, self-reliance, and sustainable livelihoods.

Today, Butterfly Charitable Trust continues to bring hope to tribal villages and underserved communities through compassion-driven initiatives. Its efforts empower communities by creating opportunities for a healthier and self-reliant future.

THE MAN BEHIND THE MISSION NEELESH INDIA



Behind every meaningful organisation is an inspiring story, and Butterfly Charitable Trust is no exception.



Neelesh, the Managing Trustee of Butterfly Charitable Trust, is an engineer by education but a humanitarian by purpose. His journey into social service did not begin with ambition it began with personal loss.

Creating Change Where It Matters Most

Growing up, Neelesh was deeply inspired by his father, a compassionate man who actively participated in Lions Club service activities and donated blood 38 times during his lifetime. His father's sudden demise while Neelesh was pursuing his engineering degree left him emotionally devastated.

For months, he struggled with grief until a visit to an orphanage on his father's death anniversary changed his perspective forever. Meeting children who had lost both parents helped him realise that service could become a pathway to healing.

This experience eventually led him to join Amanvedika, where he spent years working with vulnerable children and learning the true meaning of grassroots social work. There, he discovered that real change is built through patience, empathy, and genuine human connection. Alongside his work, motorcycle journeys across India became his source of emotional healing. Travelling through remote villages exposed him to the hardships faced by tribal communities, inspiring him to dedicate his life to serving those living in forgotten corners of the country.

Together with Aliya Parveen, an experienced social worker and development professional, Neelesh founded Butterfly Charitable Trust with one vision to transform lives by reaching people whom society often overlooks.

Following his father's legacy, Neelesh has donated blood 21 times and continues to serve society while simultaneously pursuing his lifelong dream of becoming a film director.

A Vision for the Future

Butterfly Charitable Trust envisions expanding its Tribal Bridge School, taking Project Roshni to more remote and underserved villages, strengthening educational programmes, and creating sustainable opportunities for vulnerable communities. The Trust remains committed to reaching those who need support the most bringing education, hope, dignity, and opportunity to communities that are often left behind.

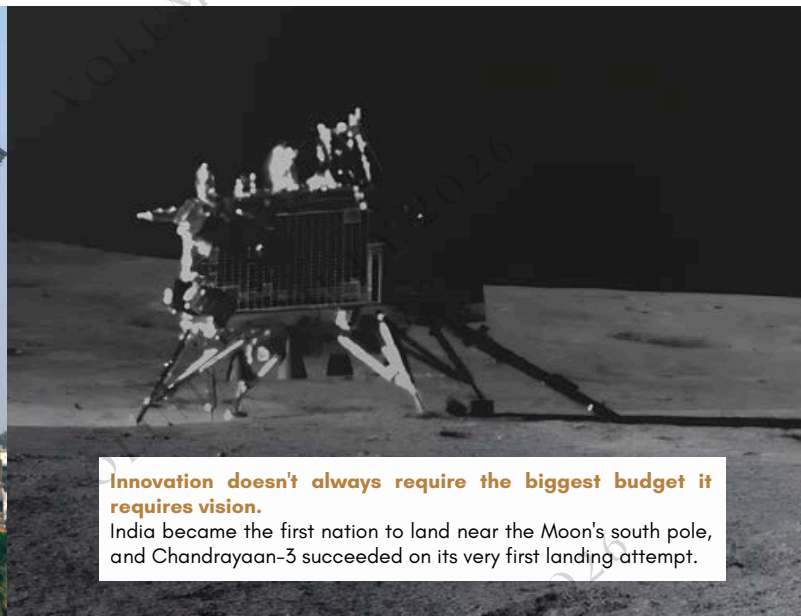
For Neelesh & Aliya Butterfly Charitable Trust believes that every life deserves an opportunity to grow, dream, and thrive. Transforming Lives is not just a motto for Butterfly Charitable Trust it is the heart of its journey: turning challenges into opportunities, compassion into action, and hope into lasting change.

"Every life touched with compassion creates a ripple of hope that transforms an entire community."

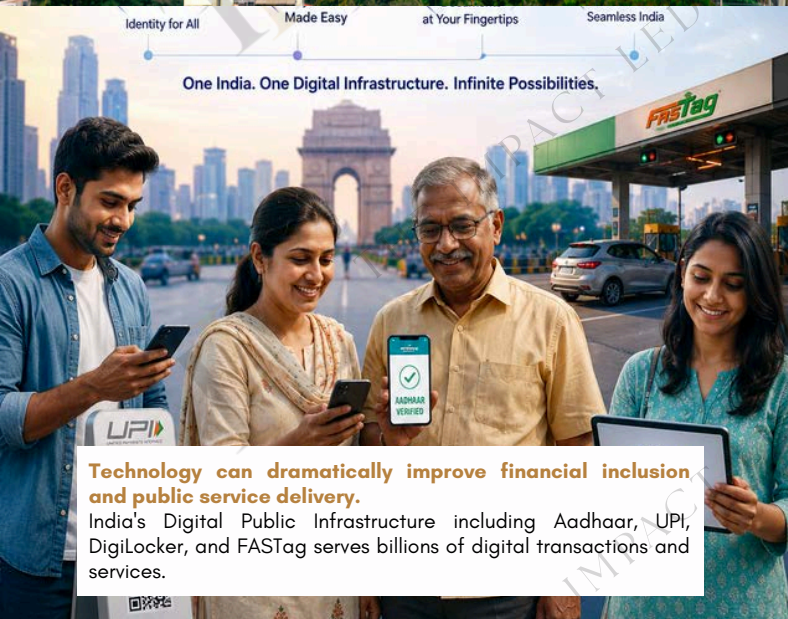
Do you *know*?



Businesses in India are legally encouraged to create measurable social impact alongside financial growth.
India became the first country in the world to legally mandate Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) spending for eligible companies.



Innovation doesn't always require the biggest budget it requires vision.
India became the first nation to land near the Moon's south pole, and Chandrayaan-3 succeeded on its very first landing attempt.



Technology can dramatically improve financial inclusion and public service delivery.
India's Digital Public Infrastructure including Aadhaar, UPI, Digilocker, and FASTag serves billions of digital transactions and services.



Grassroots talent often comes from places with the fewest resources.
Many of India's finest archers, hockey players, wrestlers, and athletes come from tribal communities, where sports are deeply connected with everyday life and culture.



Indigenous wisdom supports modern conservation.
Many tribal communities have protected forests, rivers, and biodiversity for generations using traditional ecological knowledge passed down through oral traditions.



India has welcomed global learners for over 1,500 years.
Students from China, Korea, Tibet, and Southeast Asia traveled to ancient Nalanda to study philosophy, medicine, mathematics, and astronomy.

SCIENTIFIC FACTS

**BECAUSE SMALL INSIGHTS
CREATE BIG IMPACT.**

IMPACT WORTH SHARING

01.



One mature tree absorbs around 22kg of CO₂ every year.

A single avenue of 100 trees can offset more than 2 tonnes of carbon annually.

02.



Every ₹1 invested in clean water can generate up to ₹4-7 in economic returns.

Better health, fewer sick days, improved education, and stronger local economies all contribute.

03.



Each Year of Education Opens Doors to Greater Opportunities and Higher Earning Potential

Education remains one of the high return investments for social development.

04.



Volunteering benefits the volunteer too.

Studies consistently associate regular volunteering with improved mental well-being, stronger social connections, and greater life satisfaction.

05.



More than half of the Sustainable Development Goals depend on partnerships.

Collaborate between governments, businesses, nonprofits, and communities is essential to lasting progress.

06.



Supporting women entrepreneurs creates ripple effects.

Women often reinvent a substantial share of their income into their families education, nutrition, and health.



“Impact isn’t measured by how much you give,
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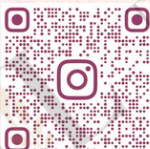
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DIFFICULT
DIRTY
DUMB
EARLY
EASY
EXPENSIVE
FAR

FAST
FAT
FRIENDLY
HAPPY
HARD
HOT
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LITTLE
LONG
LOOSE
LOUD

MEAN
OPEN
POWERFUL
RED
ROUGH
SAD
SHADY
SHALLOW
SHARP
SHORT
SLOW

SLY
SMART
SMELLY
SMOOTH
SOFT
STRONG
TALL
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FOCUS. THINK. SOLVE

Fill in the empty boxes so that each row, column and 3*3 box contains the numbers 1 to 9 only once.

PUZZLE 1

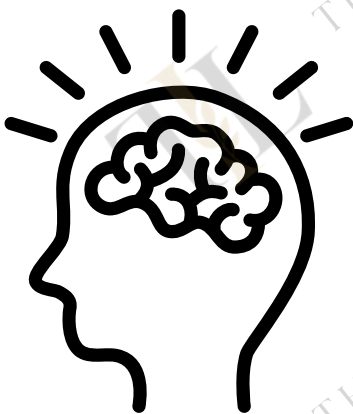
3	4			6		2		9
2		8	4	9				6
	2		3	1				
		4				1		
				2	5		4	
9				5	1	4		3
4		3		7			6	8

DIFFICULTY LEVEL : MEDIUM

PUZZLE 1

	9	1		7				
2		3					5	
			4		2	9		7
		2	8		6			9
9			1		4	6		
1		5	2		7			
	8					5		1
				1		7	6	

DIFFICULTY LEVEL : HARD

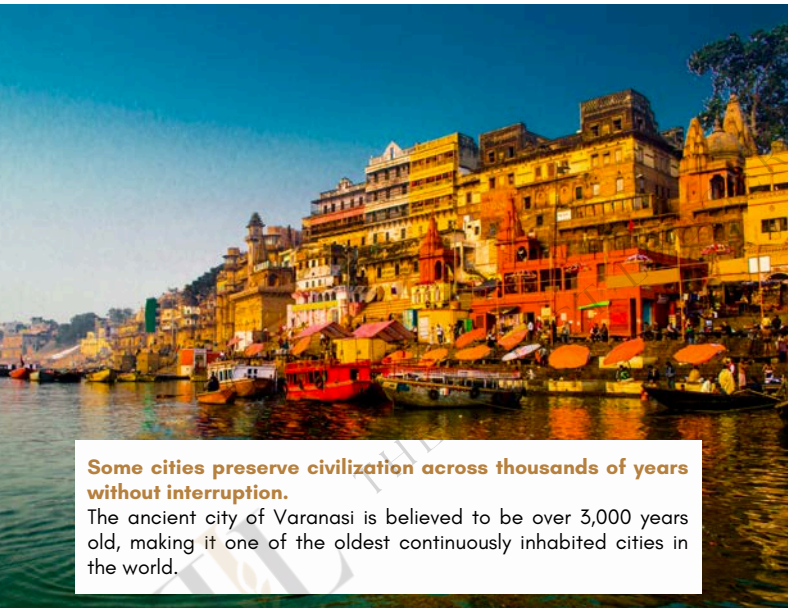


“

Life is like a game of Sudoku: every wrong move complicates the grid, but with focus and patience, every piece eventually finds its rightful place.

”

Do you know?



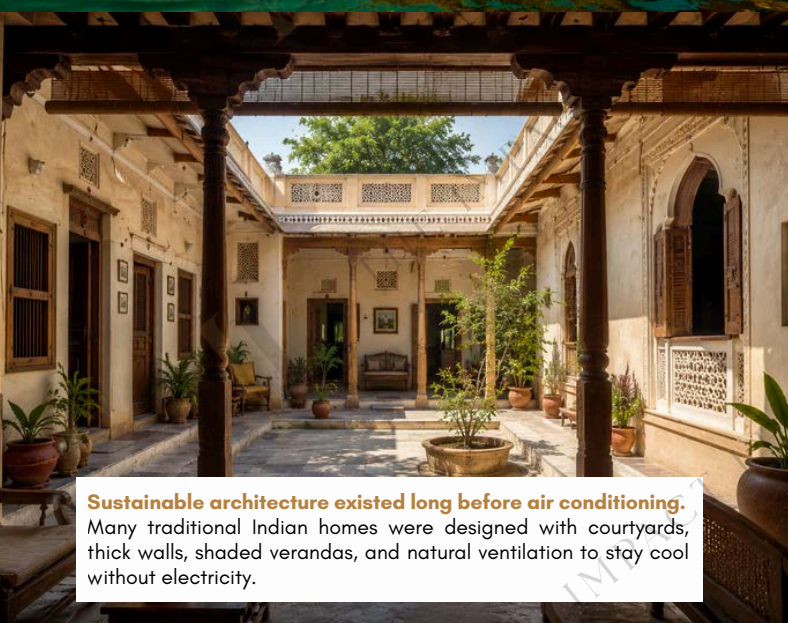
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Sustainable architecture existed long before air conditioning.

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Tradition and financial security often go hand in hand.

Indian households collectively hold one of the world's largest private reserves of gold, making it both a cultural symbol and a financial asset.



Earth's greatest landscapes are still being shaped today.

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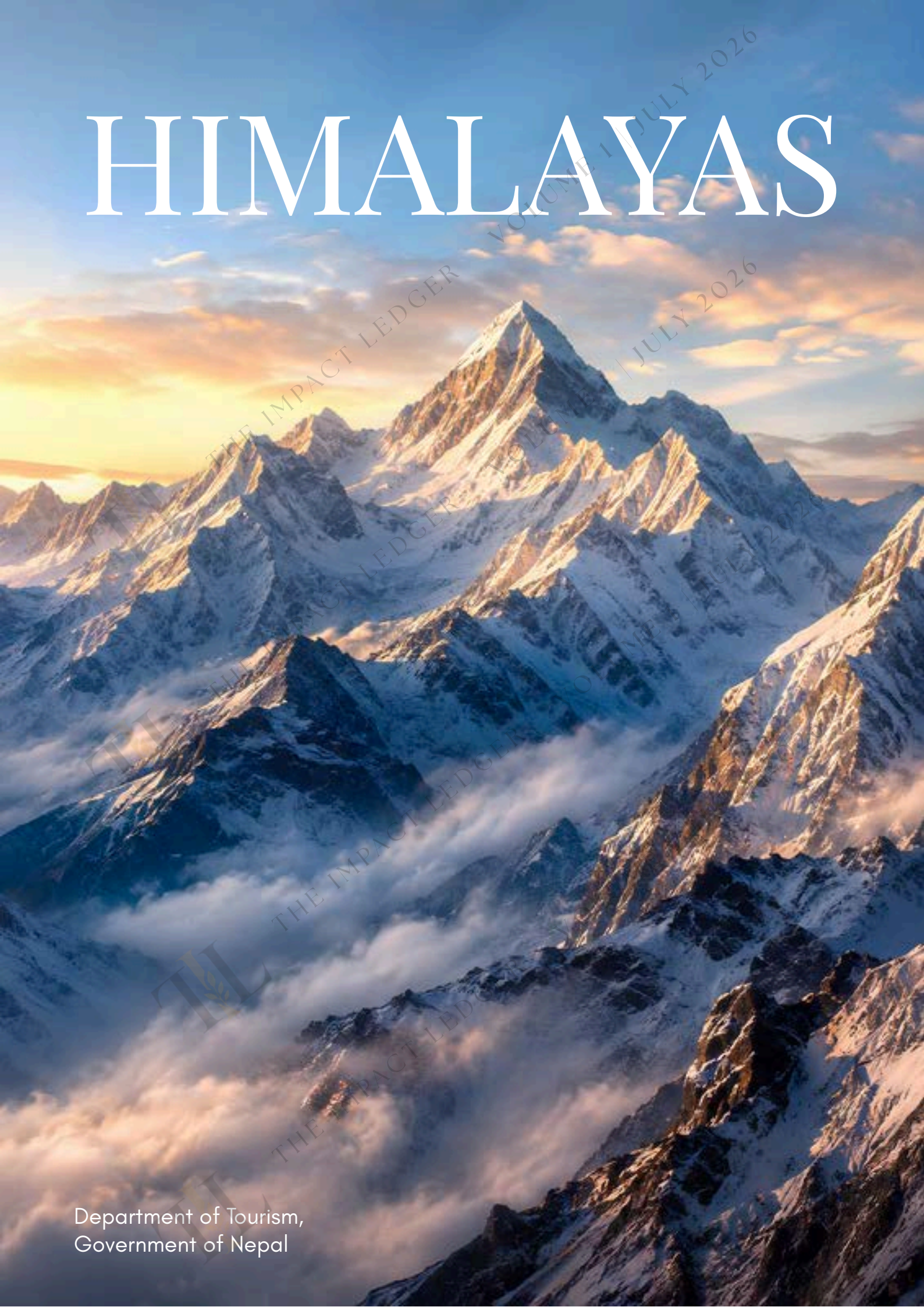


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